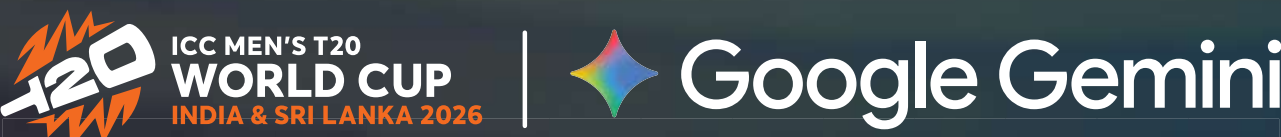


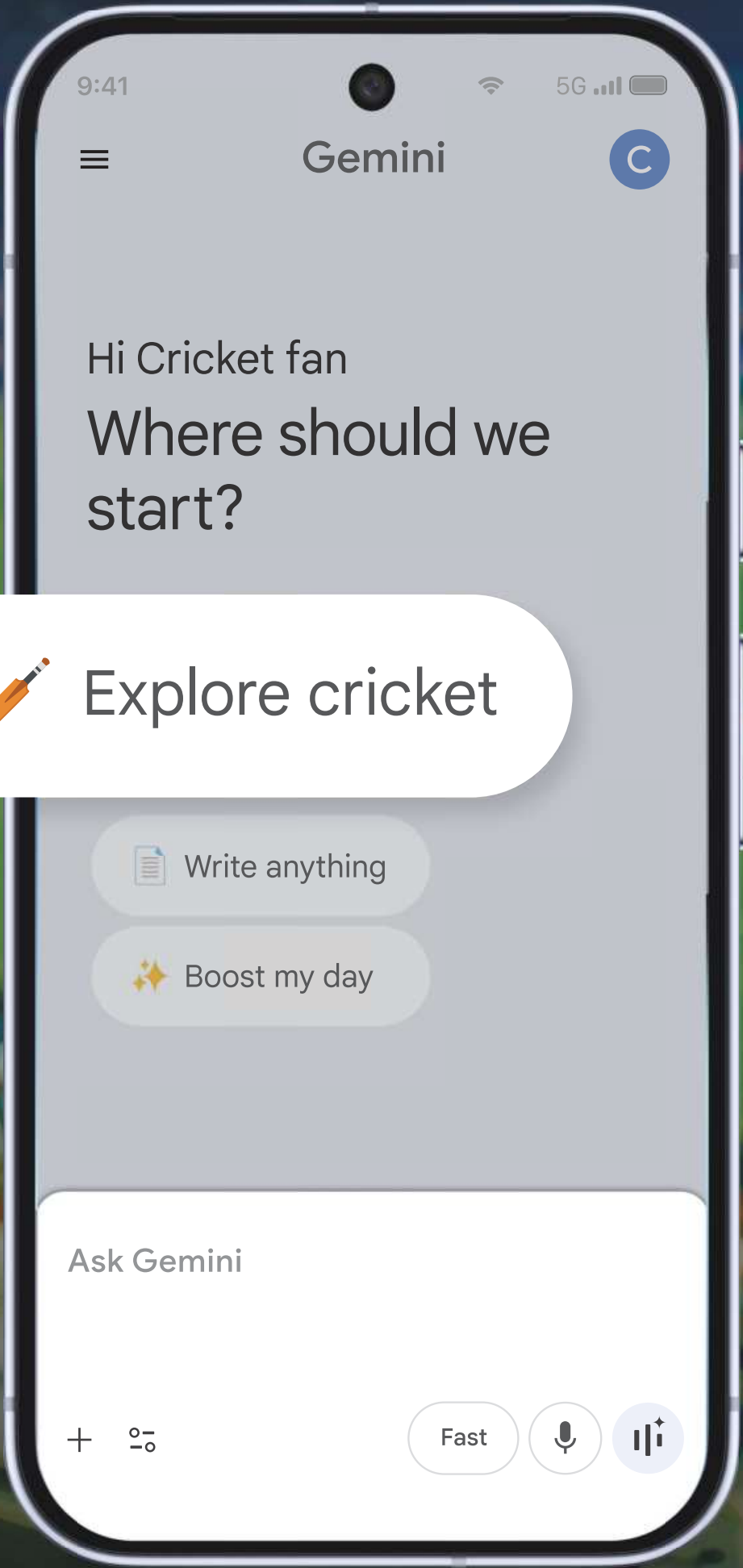
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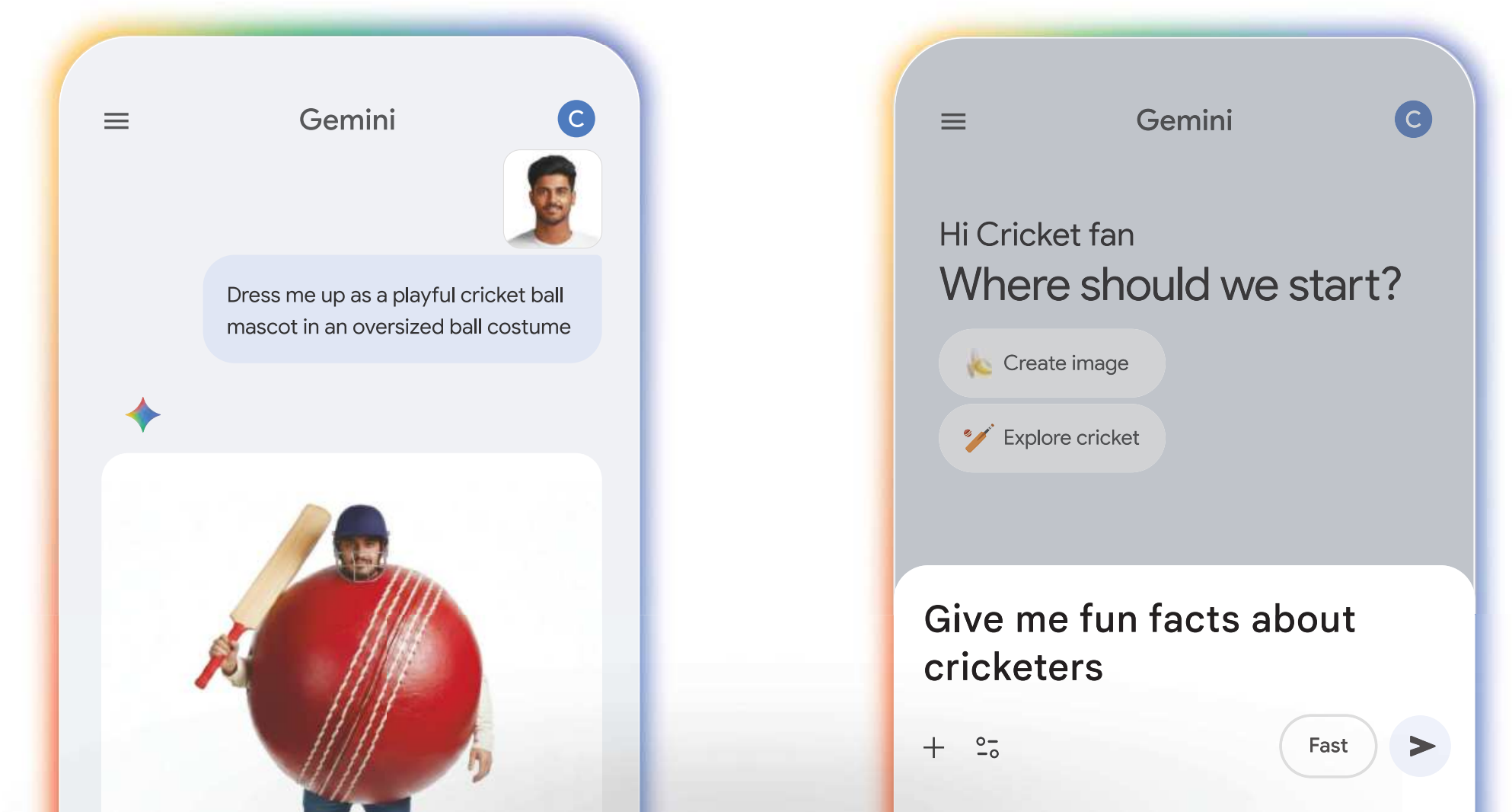


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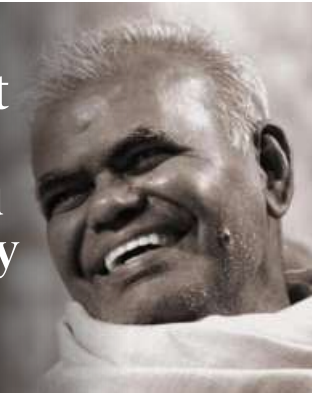
NCERT apologises over 'inappropriate' content

NEWS » PAGE 10

TIRELESS CAMPAIGNER

Communist veteran Nallakannu passes away

NEWS » PAGES 6 & 11





'COUNTERVAILING DUTY'

U.S. slaps 126% tariffs on Indian solar cells

BUSINESS » PAGE 13

SABARIMALA REVIEW

Balancing faith, rights, and dignity

Arguments will centre on India's religious freedom jurisprudence

EDITORIAL » PAGE 8



DECISIVE WIN

New Zealand knocks out co-host Sri Lanka

SPORT » PAGE 15

NEARBY



EPS accuses DMK of being a slave of Congress

CHENNAI

Rebutting the criticism of Chief Minister M.K. Stalin about his being a "slave of Delhi", AIADMK chief Edappadi K. Palaniswami has accused the DMK of being a "slave" to the Congress. » PAGE 6

'Only BJP will allocate seats to AIADMK'

CHENNAI

CPI(M) State secretary P. Shanmugam on Wednesday said it appeared that the BJP would allocate seats to the AIADMK and not the other way around in the NDA alliance in Tamil Nadu. » PAGE 6

METROPLUS » 4 PAGES

India 'stands firmly' with Israel, Modi tells Knesset

Prime Minister addresses the Israeli parliament as he begins visit to the West Asian country; India has an uncompromising policy of zero tolerance for terrorism with no double standard, he adds

Kallol Bhattacharjee

NEW DELHI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi, in his address to the Knesset on Wednesday, extended a firm hand of friendship to Israel and condemned the Hamas attack on October 7, 2023 as a "barbaric terrorist attack".

Speaking at the Israeli parliament, the Prime Minister supported the Gaza Peace Initiative saying it was necessary to "sustain" the process of peace building in the region.

"The Gaza Peace Initiative that was endorsed by the UN Security Council offers a pathway. India has expressed its firm support for the initiative... We believe that it holds the promise of a just and durable



Prime Minister Narendra Modi being greeted by Israeli PM Benjamin Netanyahu at the Knesset in Jerusalem on Wednesday. ANI

peace for all the people of the region, including by addressing the Palestine issue," he said.

Bilateral relations

Mr. Modi said India and Israel were working to enhance bilateral relations across sectors such as water management, agricul-

ture, and talent partnership, adding that he had discussed "key developments" in the region with Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu.

"I also carry with me the deepest condolences of the people of India for every life lost and for every family whose world was

shattered in the barbaric terrorist attack by Hamas on October 7," said Mr. Modi, adding that India stands with Israel "firmly, with full conviction".

In his second visit to Israel as Prime Minister, Mr. Modi reminded the members of the Knesset about India's own struggle against terrorism and cited the 26/11 terror attack in Mumbai that killed citizens of India as well as multiple other countries, including Israel.

"Like you, we have a consistent and uncompromising policy of zero tolerance for terrorism, with no double standard," the Prime Minister said.

CONTINUED ON

» PAGE 10

RAHUL TARGETS PM'S TRIP

» PAGE 11

Cases stall as judicial officers busy with SIR in West Bengal

Shiv Sahay Singh

KOLKATA

Judicial work in the district and metropolitan courts across West Bengal has been severely affected after hundreds of judicial officers were deployed to process nearly 50 lakh claims and objections under the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls ahead of the February 28 deadline.

Except for urgent matters and bail hearings, trials and regular proceedings – including in special courts such as those dealing with Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) cases – have been affected as judges undertake verification work.

Committees have been formed at the Calcutta High Court and district levels to reassign urgent cases to alternative courts, but litigants and judicial officers remain uncertain about

Judicial crunch

SC has directed judiciary to verify about **50 lakh** claims and objections in West Bengal

■ Calcutta HC has deployed 294 judicial officers for verifications

■ Trials as well as other hearings before district courts and metropolitan courts in the State have stalled following the deployment



when normal functioning will resume. Now that it has fallen to the judiciary to examine claims and objections, judicial officers have reached out to administrative complexes for the verification work.

CONTINUED ON

» PAGE 10

RELATED REPORTS ON

» PAGE 11

PM's frequent visits to T.N. will backfire on NDA: Stalin

The Hindu Bureau

NAGERCOIL

Observing that Prime Minister Narendra Modi would be visiting Tamil Nadu frequently in view of the Assembly election, Chief Minister and DMK president M.K. Stalin on Wednesday said the more he visits the State, the bigger the margin of defeat would be for the National Democratic Alliance (NDA).

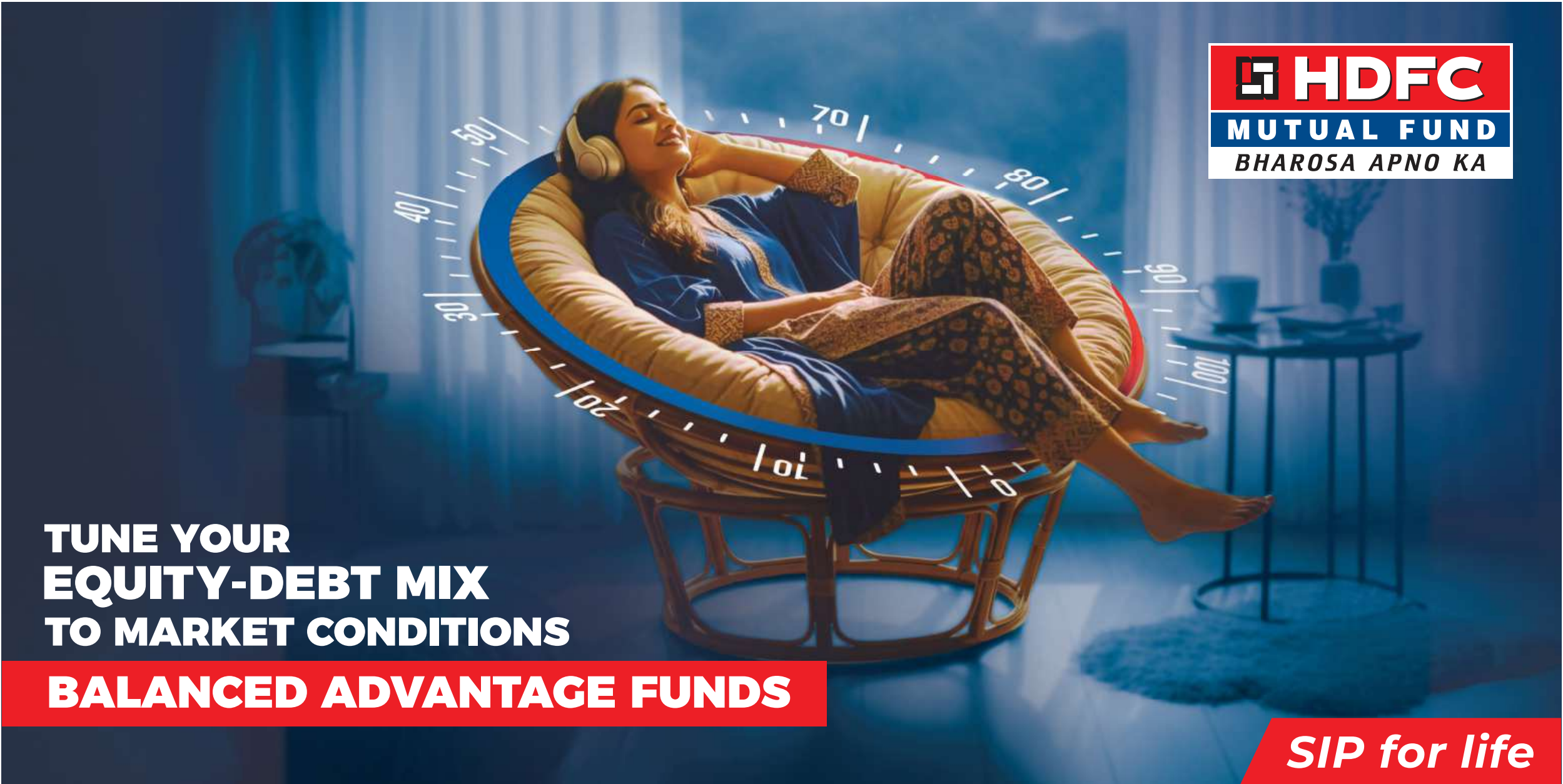
'Allies are anxious'

Speaking at an event held in Nagercoil to distribute welfare assistance, Mr. Stalin said Mr. Modi's allies were anxious about his visits.

The Chief Minister said the people of Tamil Nadu would remember that the Prime Minister had done nothing for the State.

CONTINUED ON

» PAGE 6



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INBRIEF



Samsung union to intensify stir for reinstating 27 workers

Employees affiliated to the Samsung India Workers' Union (SIWU) plan to intensify the protest against the failure to reinstate 27 employees who were removed from the factory in Sriperumbudur a year ago. A large number of employees of the trade union, which is affiliated to the Centre of Indian Trade Unions (CITU), decided to take out a protest march to the Secretariat in the coming days to urge the State government to intervene in this issue.E. Muthukumar, SIWU president, said Labour Welfare and Skill Development Minister C.V. Ganesan had promised in the Assembly last month that these employees would be reinstated, but the Samsung management had not taken any steps to reinstate them. CITU leader A. Soundararajan echoed the demand for the State government's intervention in reinstating the sacked employees.

Text & Context and Science

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carry explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (February 26, Thursday), the following articles are available:

- How are Indian firms training LLMs? newsth.live/llmsarvamexp
- Craig the elephant, and the promise and problem of wildlife icons newsth.live/wildlifesuperstars

You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access these articles. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access an article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

7 suffer burns after cylinder explodes at jewellery unit

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Seven persons, including a jewellery shop owner, suffered burns after a gas cylinder exploded at a goldsmith's unit in Sowcarpet on Wednesday night. The incident occurred when gold ornaments were being melted at the unit, which operated from the fourth floor of a building on Singannan Street. The blast sparked a fire. On hearing the blast, residents in the area alerted the police and Fire and Rescue Services. Subsequently, firefighters from nearby stations went to the spot and quickly brought the blaze under control.

Natives of Kolkata
The shop owner, Suman Paul of Vyasarpadi, and six workers, all natives of Kolkata, were injured in the incident. They were initially taken to the Rajiv Gandhi Government General Hospital, and later shifted to the Government Kilpauk Medical College Hospital for specialised treatment. Police sources said Mr. Paul suffered around 40% burns, while the others sustained around 20% burns each. The Elephant Gate Police Station registered a case and launched an investigation to ascertain the cause of the blast.

Motorists complain of bumpy ride on newly built flyover

They say Madhya Kailash flyover does not offer a smooth ride; highway officials point out that the surface was kept rough to prevent speeding

STORIES FROM THE ROAD

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A section of motorists has complained that the recently opened flyover at Madhya Kailash does not offer a smooth ride and that the surface is bumpy in places. Social media saw posts from users appreciating the flyover, which was opened on February 16, saying it removed the need to wait at the signal. However, they also complained that the ride was bumpy, with a post on social media even comparing it to horse riding. Another post on X by Narayanan Hariharan said: "Took the new flyover at Madhya Kailash and it was so bumpy. Have we forgotten how to build smooth surfaces? and it is not like they built this overnight." A resident of Perumbakkam, Vijay Karthick, who is in the construction industry, said that measures taken to slow down vehicles added to the uneven road



Essential facility: The Madhya Kailash flyover was opened for traffic on February 16. R. RAVINDRAN

surface. "The flyover is newly constructed; it will take time for it to settle. People are used to bituminous tar (BT) topping that is usually laid on other flyovers. This flyover has BT on both the approach ramps. It would be good if the entire flyover has BT," Mr. Karthick further said. Sources in the Highways Department said the cement concrete layer was smoothened to the extent possible, based on the sug-

gestions of the Bridge Monitoring and the Road Safety wings. "We let the surface be a bit rough so that vehicles do not speed up on the flyover. If a BT layer is laid now, in the future, cold milling the top layer may not be possible, and it will only be dead weight. Since the public feels that there are too many bumps, we will smoothen out more points," an official source said.

Southern Railway to commission MRTS Velachery-St. Thomas Mount project soon

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Southern Railway is planning to commission the Mass Rapid Transit System (MRTS) extension project from Velachery to St. Thomas Mount station by March 10. The move comes in the wake of commuters complaining about the hardships faced due to the reduction of suburban train services at the Egmore railway station to facilitate redevelopment work. Southern Railway had announced that the suburban train services would be reduced for 45 days – from February 20 to April 5. It said in a press release that the commencement of MRTS services from St. Thomas Mount to Beach would reduce the burden on commuters affected by the cancellation of suburban services on the Beach-Tambaram and Chengalpattu section and increase commuter patronage for MRTS services. Facing severe criticism from various political parties for reducing the suburban train services, Southern Railway has planned to operate 15-car electrical multiple units for 10 services, with five services each

Southern Railway plans to operate 15-car electrical multiple units for 10 services from Beach to Tambaram
on the up and down directions from Beach to Tambaram. The special services would have limited stops at Tambaram, Mambalam, Guindy, Egmore, and Beach. At present, only 12 car rakes are being operated on the section. **Special bus trips**
As per the request of Southern Railway, the Metropolitan Transport Corporation would operate 20 special bus trips from the Tambaram railway station to Beach via Guindy, Anna Salai, Chepauk, and the Secretariat, during the morning and evening peak hours. The special trips have been arranged free of cost for commuters holding season tickets and daily tickets. The special buses would have stops at Sanatorium, Chromepet, Pallavaram, Tirusulam, Guindy, Ezhilagam, Secretariat, and Parry's Corner.

Panel seeks promotion counselling for dental doctors

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Legal Coordination Committee for Government Doctors has urged the State government to conduct promotion counselling for dental doctors, fill the posts of assistant professors in dentistry

through the Medical Services Recruitment Board, and restore the reduced dental posts. The association said in a statement that no promotion counselling had been conducted for dental doctors since 2014. Only five departments at the Tamil Nadu Government Dental

College in Chennai had promotion counselling up to 2023. Currently, 30 associate professor posts and 20 professor posts remain vacant. A total of 30 assistant professor posts in dentistry in medical colleges and 27 dental surgeon posts in Directorate of Medical and Rural Health

Services hospitals remain vacant. For more than 10 years, no new appointments for dental doctors have been made, it said. For the Dental Council of India inspection at the Chidambaram and Pudukottai Dental Colleges, doctors from hospitals in Chennai, Kancheepuram,

Rameswaram, Krishnagiri, and Vellore were transferred, the association said. It demanded the cancellation of an order extending the service of a retired dental professor and creation of dental posts in all government hospitals and primary health centres.

Qualifying marks for persons with disabilities revised in TET

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu's School Education Department has fixed the passing marks for persons with disabilities (PwDs) taking up the

Teacher Eligibility Test (TET) at 60 out of 150. According to a Government Order, the government accepted the proposal and fixed the minimum qualifying marks for PwDs in TET at 40%.

Previously, the government had fixed the minimum qualifying marks at 50%. The order said these minimum qualifying marks must be followed for the TET already held.

Ahead of Assembly poll, various associations put forth several demands

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Be it the 275 data entry operators in the Tamil Nadu Civil Supplies Corporation (TNCSC) or organic farmers, all of them have been holding press meets and staging protests, desperately wanting to be heard before the Assembly election is announced. The TNCSC Computer Operators' Association – comprising 275 members who have been working on contract since 2009, managing stocks at godowns and ensuring supplies to fair price shops – have demanded that their members be appointed to the existing vacancies at the respective godowns. "We joined for a pay of ₹13,688. But recently, this was reduced to ₹11,300. We want the DMK government to keep its 2021 poll promise and make our jobs permanent," A. Manivanan, general secretary of the association, said. The Tamil Nadu Qualified Yoga Teachers' Association wants 250 of its members, who teach yoga at primary health centres and government schools, to be paid the wages for 2023-24 and 2024-25. "The training was provided under the Ayushman Bharat scheme. The Centre has released ₹1.50 crore for

Permanent jobs, higher wages, and incentives are among the demands raised by teachers, computer operators, labourers and organic farmers
wages, but the State government has not paid that amount. Instead, it sacked the yoga teachers and tried to appoint those who had Bachelor of Naturopathy and Yoga Sciences degrees in that place. Since we went to court, we have not been paid our salaries," said association secretary V. Kasinathadurai. **Wait continues**
The 2018 Motor Vehicle Inspector Grade II Examiners' Association has urged the government to either appoint or provide provisional selection orders to those who were chosen during the interviews held in 2023. The members of this association wrote exams in 2018, but the selection process was kept in abeyance since 28 persons went to court. M. Senthilkumar, coordinator, says that of the 113 vacant posts, 28 could be kept for those who went to court and the rest be filled with their members. The general secretary of the Tamil Nadu Regulated

Market Committee Weigh Labourers' Union, A.V. Saravanan, said that over 20,000 members of the union had been working as daily wage labourers since the time of the British. They were paid ₹12.50 per 75-kg bag by the farmers who brought their produce to the market to weigh them, change the items to different gunny bags, and keep them in storage. "In each committee, work begins by 4 a.m. and they work till well after noon. They do not have any medical insurance or pension. We demand that these men be given permanent jobs and all benefits," he said. The Tamil Nadu Organic Farmers' Federation has demanded that a welfare board be set up, an annual incentive amount of ₹24,000 per acre be paid to organic farmers, and at least 25% of the State Budget be allotted for organic food procurement for the public distribution system by government agencies. "We also want incentives to be given to farmers who conserve and share native seeds," said Vetrimaran, organic farmer and trainer. Suresh, another organic farmer, sought markets and organic food processing centres at the block and district levels.

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PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform everyone that our client, Mr. S. Moorthy, has been duly elected as General Secretary of the Tamil Nadu Electricity Workers Federation (TNEWF), Regd. No. 2970. This union is affiliated with AIFEE & AITUC, and its office is at V.G.R. Illam, No.92, Guruvappa Street, Chintadripet, Chennai-2.

The election took place on 01.02.2025. It was supervised by the Administrator appointed by the Hon'ble High Court of Madras- Hon'ble Justice G. Chockalingam (Retd. Judge of Madras High Court)-following the court's directions in C.S. No. 146 of 2024. Following the High Court's orders dated 21.03.2025 and 23.03.2025, the Administrator handed over all TNEWF records, documents, cheques, and building keys to Mr. S. Moorthy on 03.04.2025.

Please note: Mr. S. Moorthy is the legally recognized General Secretary of TNEWF (Regd. No. 2970). He alone has the sole authority to: Convene and conduct all official TNEWF meetings, Represent the Federation before any authority. Handle all welfare activities for TNEWF members and office bearers. Issue notices, circulars, communications, and public statements on behalf of TNEWF.

Represent the Federation and share official information through WhatsApp, Facebook, or any other social media platforms and messaging services. No person other than the General Secretary is authorized to use these platforms to represent or post on behalf of the Federation. He is also authorized to operate all TNEWF bank accounts jointly with the newly elected Treasurer, Thiru N. Aruldass, at every bank where the Federation has accounts.

Anyone else-whether an individual, group, or organization, trying to act in the name of TNEWF hold meetings, issue notices, use the official letterhead, approach TNEB administration for concessions or representation, or touch the Federation's bank accounts will be acting without authority. This violates the Hon'ble High Court of Madras orders. Such actions are illegal, void, and carry legal weight.

Final notice to all concerned: This applies to all TNEWF members and office bearers; all employees and officers of TNEB Ltd., TNPDCL, TNGECL, TNPGL, and TANTRANSCO; Chief Engineers, Superintending Engineers, Executive Engineers, and officials in all Regional, Circle, and Division offices; the Labour Department of the Government of Tamil Nadu; and the public at large.

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Place: Madurai
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RISE	14:27	SET	02:52
SATURDAY, FEB. 28			
RISE	06:26	SET	18:18
RISE	15:30	SET	03:49

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Four escape after vehicle catches fire in Nandanam

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A 20-year-old man and three others escaped unhurt after their car caught fire in Nandanam on Tuesday night.

The police said A. Dhanush of Jafferkanpet was travelling to Saidapet with his friends in his car. When they reached Pasumpon Muthuramalingam Road in Nandanam, Dhanush noticed smoke coming from the AC vent. He stopped the car to check the engine. Subsequently, its front portion caught fire.

On information, Fire and Rescue Services personnel rushed to the spot and put out the fire, but the car was gutted.

History-sheeter hacked to death near Periyapalayam; four persons held

CHENNAI: The Tiruvallur district police have arrested four men in connection with the murder of a 26-

year-old history-sheeter near Periyapalayam on Tuesday night. Police sources said Go-

kul of Ariyapakkam was hacked to death by an unidentified gang, and his body was found on a vacant

land in Thanduma Nagar on Wednesday. They sent the body for post-mortem. An inquiry revealed that

Gokul was murdered during a drunken brawl. The police analysed his call records, and within two

hours of the incident, secured the four accused. Further investigation is under way.

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ISSN 0971 - 751X

CM YK M CH-CHE



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(CIN: U40108JH2013SGC001702)
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HEC, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004.
fax # 0651-2400483 e-mail : cesp.jseb@rediffmail.com
/gmsh.jbvn@rediffmail.com



CANCELLATION NOTICE
Due to some unavoidable circumstances
NIT No. 353/PR/JBVNL/2024-25 is hereby
cancelled.

स्वहित एवं राष्ट्रहित में ऊर्जा बचाव। कृपया अपनी शिकयतों को 18003456570(कॉल सेंटर) पर दर्ज कराये।

PR No. 347965

Sd/-
General Manager (S&P)
JBVNL

PR 373584 Jharkhand Bijlee Vitran Nigam Ltd(25-26)#D

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THE HINDU

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WESTERN RAILWAY
Material Management Department
VARIOUS MATERIALS SUPPLY

E-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE No. S/10/2026 Date 20.02.2026

S.N.	Tender No	Short Description of Items	Quantity	T.O.D.
71	26267021	Running Contract for One Year for supply of HVN-66 insulating Liner as per RDSO Drawing No. T-6938 to 6939	250000 Set	23-Mar-26
72	04253621A	Fire Retardant Curtain Cloth	16101 Mtr	23-Mar-26
73	26267019	Running Contract of One Year for supply of 10 mm thick CGRSP to RDSO Drawing No T-8528 All. 1	200000 Nos	18-Mar-26

Regarding detailed notice EMD, Purchase restrictions and detailed tender conditions, please visit website www.ireps.gov.in and wr.indianrailways.gov.in. 1156

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Kalyan Singh Super Speciality Cancer Institute
C.G. City, Sultanpur Road, Lucknow-226002
Website: <https://cancerinstitute.edu.in>, Email: jdmn.sscsi@gmail.com

GeM Bid Notice
It is hereby informed that a bids No. is as follow:-

Sr. No.	Name of Service	Bid No. & Date	Pre-bid Meeting Date & Time
1.	Operation And Maintenance of Fire Fighting System-Complete System	GEM/2026/B/7289402 Dated 25.02.2026	27.02.2026 15:00 P.M.

The Bid uploaded on GeM Portal for Procurement of **Service Bid** at KSSSCI. All interested service providers/bidders are required to submit their bids on GeM Portal in accordance with the terms and conditions of the GeM bid documents. The Director reserves the right to accept or reject any or all bids at any stage without assigning any reason thereof.
The Tender documents are available on the website of the Institute www.cancerinstitute.edu.in
Advt No:- KSSSCI/Tender-27/2025-26 Director



ODISHA STATE AGRICULTURAL MARKETING BOARD (OSAMB)
(A Statutory Organization of Govt. of Odisha)
Plot No.1800 (P), Baramunda, Post-Khandagiri, Near Indian Oil Petrol Pump, Bhubaneswar.
Ph.No.0674-2952410, Email: osamboard99@yahoo.com

Corrigendum
No.762 Date.24.02.2026
Bid Identification of e-Procurement Notice No.-1 of 2025-2026, Tender Call Notice No.- 622 Dated:11.02.2026
“Construction of World Largest Grain Storage in Co-operative Sector”
QUALIFICATION CRITERIA, 3.2 (b)
XVI. Experience: Contractor having Successfully completed 500 MT Godown or above in a Single Agreement during the last 3 Financial Years.
Read as
Experience : Contractor having Successfully completed 1000 MT Godown or above in a Single Agreement during the last 3 Financial Years for the Work of TENDER CALL NOTICE No.- 622 Dated : 11.02.2026, SI. No. 1, 2, 3 & 4
All other Terms & Conditions will remain unchanged.
Sd/- General Manager, OSAM Board, Bhubaneswar
39001/15/2526 QIPR-39001/390241/1/25-26/0004

GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB
Municipal Corporation Amritsar
Tender Reference No. E-Tender Notice No. 172 Date 24.02.2026

The Department of : Municipal Corporation, Amritsar Invites Bid for
“Construction of Heritage Entrance Gate around Walled City Amritsar” (Amt. Rs. 6,08,05,561/-)
Closing Date and Time : 12.03.2026 upto 03:00 PM
EMD : 2% of Estimate Amount .
For Detail log onto : <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>
Note : Any Corrigendum(s) to the tender notice shall be published on the above website only.
Superintending Engineer(c)
Municipal Corporation,
Amritsar.
1596/12/2025-26/8763



National Highways Authority of India
(Ministry of Road Transport and Highways)

भर्ती सूचना / RECRUITMENT NOTICE
भा.रा.रा.प्र., प्रतिनियुक्ति आधार पर निम्नलिखित पद के लिए भर्ती हेतु आवेदन आमंत्रित करता है:-
NHAI invites applications for recruitment to the following post on Deputation basis:-

Name of the post	No.	Pay Scale
उप प्रबंधक (सतर्का) Deputy Manager (Vigilance)	01	पे मैट्रिक्स में लेवल-10 (रु.56100-177500) Level-10 in the Pay Matrix (Rs. 56100-177500)

2. भा.रा.रा.प्र. की वेबसाइट (www.nhai.gov.in) पर उपलब्ध विस्तृत विज्ञापन में दी गई प्रक्रिया के अनुसार आवेदक दिनांक 27.03.2026 (सां 06:00 बजे तक) ऑनलाइन आवेदन जमा सुनिश्चित करें।
The applicant is required to ensure submission of online application as per the procedure indicated in the detailed advertisement available on NHAI website (www.nhai.gov.in), by 27.03.2026 (upto 06:00 PM).
3. आयु सीमा, योग्यता मानदंड, अन्य शर्तें आदि से संबंधित विस्तृत विवरण भा.रा.रा.प्र. की वेबसाइट पर देखे जा सकते हैं।
Details regarding age limit, eligibility criteria, other conditions etc. may be accessed on NHAI website.
4. इस विज्ञापन के संबंध में सुझाव/अनुशेष/निरसोक्ति, यदि कोई हो, तो उसे केवल भा.रा.रा.प्र. की वेबसाइट पर प्रकाशित किया जाएगा।
Corrigendum/Addendum/Cancellation to this advertisement, if any, shall be published on NHAI website only.
BUILDING A NATION, NOT JUST ROADS



GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA - ST & SC DEVELOPMENT DEPARTMENT
OFFICE OF THE PROJECT ADMINISTRATOR, ITDA, NILGIRI
e-Procurement Notice
e-procurement Notice Bid Identification No. ITDANGR-02/2025-26
Notice No. 95 / ITDA, Date:- 23.02.2026
The project Administrator, ITDA, Nilgiri on behalf of Governor of odisha invites Percentage Rate bids in online mode for construction of the work detailed below:
1. Nature of the work : Const. of 1st floor of Auditorium Building of SCSTRTI, Bhubaneswar & 2nd & 3rd floor of PVTG building of SCSTRTI, Bhubaneswar, etc.
2. Total No. of work : 2 (Two) nos. (Approximately)
3. Estimated Cost : Rs., 1,49,61,400/- to Rs. 2,99,96,400/- (Approximately)
4. Class of Contractor : "B" Class & "B" & "A" Class.
5. Period of Completion : Eleven Calendar Months
6. Availability of Bids : 10.00 AM of 02.03.2026 to 5.00 PM of 16.03.2026.
7. Date of opening & scrutiny : 11.00 A.M of 17.03.2026.
to technical bid
The bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. The details will be available in the website www.tendersorissa.gov.in from 10.00 AM of 02.03.2026 to 5.00 PM of 16.03.2026.
Project Administrator, ITDA, Nilgiri
26001/4/2526 QIPR-26001/260551/1/25-26/0001

ଓଡ଼ିଶା ବିଦ୍ୟୁତ୍ ଶକ୍ତି ସଂଚାରଣ ନିଗମ लि॥
(ଓଡ଼ିଶା ସରକାରଙ୍କ ଏକ ଉପକ୍ରମ)
Regd. Office: OPTCL Tech Tower, Janpath, Saheed Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751007



ODISHA POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED
(A Government of Odisha Undertaking)

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

E-Tender No.	Tender Description:	Estimated Cost
CPC-57/2025-26	Design, engineering, supply, erection, testing & commissioning of work towards Construction of 400kV D/C (Quad) line from proposed NITPP, NLC, Talabira to 400/220/132/33kV Grid S/S, Lapanga (Line Length=6.8 Km Approx.) in Sambalpur District of Odisha on EPC Contract Basis in e-tendering mode only. Last Date & Time of Submission of Bid: 25.03.2026 upto 12:45 PM.	Rs. 1,00,07,25,521.00/-

Complete set of bidding documents are available at www.tenderwizard.com/OPTCL and www.optcl.co.in.
©/optcl.odisha /optcl_odisha HIPR-77/2025-26



THE HINDU

Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER
CORRIGENDUM
In reference with corrigendum 1 dated 24.02.2026 for E-Tender notice no. LHBUpgradetolets-1500-R-1 published earlier by Dy. Chief Mechanical Engineer, Kharagpur Carriage workshop with corrigendum "regarding working days, payment condition and delivery schedule has been issued". Detail Tender Notice and Tender Document with corrigendum is available in the e-Portal website <https://www.ireps.gov.in> (PR-1235/C)

CENTRAL RAILWAY
SUPPLY AND INSTALLATION WORK
Dy. Chief Material Manager (CWE), C & W Workshop Matunga, Mumbai-400019. **Tender Notice No: CWE/MTN/85265377/2026 due on 25-Mar-2026. Tender Title:** Supply and Installation of Set of Aerosol based Fire detection and Suppression system carriage on 618 Motor Coaches of M/S Siemens M/S Bombardier and M/S Medha EMU rakes as per Annexure G-1 of RDSO specification No.RDSO/PE/SPEC/AC/0192-2018 (REV-1) and RDSO letter no. EL/7.1.108/MSSBC dated 17.09.2021 as per Scope of Supply and Installation attached in Annexure. All necessary modification and accessories required for the installation of this item shall be within scope of supplier. **Qty:** 1 Set. **Due Date:** 25-Mar-2026. **Value:** 63516002. **AK-933**
Unauthorized crossing of railway line is a punishable offense



Government of India
NATIONAL HIGHWAYS AUTHORITY OF INDIA
(MINISTRY OF ROAD TRANSPORT & HIGHWAYS)



PUBLIC NOTICE
ON REVISED USER FEE RATES AT GANGARAMPALAYAM FEE PLAZA APPLICABLE FROM 01.04.2026 (00:00 HRS)
The Public are hereby informed that pursuant to Fee Notification Published in the Gazette vide S.O.No.4385 (E) dated 08.10.2024 by MoRTH and approved revised User fee rates vide letter dated 17.02.2026 issued by NHAI, the User fee for the use of section from Km.0.000 to Km.29.000 of Villupuram to Pudukcherry Section of NH-332 for a length of 29 Km in Villupuram to Nagapattinam corridor shall be revised in line with NH Fee Rules 2008 [G.S.R. 838 (E) dated 05.12.2008] and subsequent amendments w.e.f. 01.04.2026 (00:00 HRS) at Gangarampalayam Fee Plaza (Km.18.500) near Gangarampalayam Village, Villupuram Taluk, Villupuram District in the State of Tamil Nadu at the following rates :- Amount in Rs.

Sl. No	Category of vehicles	Fee for single journey	Fee for return journey within a day	Fee for monthly pass for 50 single journeys in a month	Fee for single journey for Commercial vehicles registered with in the district
1	Car, Jeep, Van or Light Motor Vehicle	60	90	2045	30
2	Light Commercial Vehicles, Light Goods Vehicle or Mini Bus	100	150	3305	50
3	Bus / Truck (Two Axle)	210	310	6925	105
4	Three Axle commercial Vehicle	225	340	7550	115
5	Heavy Construction Machinery (HCM) or Earth Moving Equipment (EME) or Multi Axle Vehicle (MAV) (4 to 6 axles)	325	490	10855	165
6	Overized vehicles (7 or more Axles)	395	595	13215	200

The rate of monthly pass applicable for local non-commercial vehicle residing within a distance of 20 km from the fee plaza shall be Rs.350/- for FY 2026-27.

Project Director
National Highways Authority of India,
Pudukcherry

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KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD
(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar
Bengaluru - 560 009. Phone No. 080-22265383, website: www.kiadb.in
No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-EP-89/3763/2025-26 Date: 25.02.2026
SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER
(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)
Item rate Tender under two cover bid system is invited as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Civil Contractors who have got adequate financial resources, suitable construction equipments, technical man power & sufficient past experience for the work mentioned below:
Name of the Work : Re-construction & Strengthening of 24m, 18m, 12m, 9m wide Roads, construction of RCC Side Drain, RCC Cross Drainage, HDPE Water Supply Line at Jigani Industrial Area 1st & 2nd Phase, Bengaluru South District.
The last date and time of receipt of tender is : **16.03.2026 upto 04:00 pm.**
Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in>.
Sd/-
Chief Engineer-1, KIADB Bengaluru
DIPR/CP/5862/Zen/2025-26

CENTRAL RAILWAY
BRAKE CALIPER UNIT
Dy. Chief Material Manager (CWE), C & W Workshop Matunga, Mumbai-400019. **Tender Notice No: CWE/MTN/85257618/2026 due on 23-Mar-2026. Tender Title:** Set consists 3 items of brake calipers with brake cylinders for LHB-EOG coach of M/s. Faiveley (FTIL) make confirming to RDSO specification No: RDSO/2011/CG-04 rev-03. (1)Brake caliper unit leverage ratio of 2.17 to FTIL Part No.D127550-600 Qty.04 Nos. per set. (2)Brake Cylinder PBEC (90 deg) to FTIL Part No.4F-130199 Qty.02 Nos. per set. (3) Brake Cylinder PBEC (270 deg) to FTIL Part No.4F-130200 Qty.02 Nos. per set. Accepted make: Item Code 3316N284. **Qty:** 10 Set. **Due Date:** 23-Mar-2026. **Value:** 11150457. **AK-934**
Unauthorized crossing of railway line is a punishable offense



EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE NO.- SEE-GSU-BLT-25-26-02
CAO/CON/RSP/MHX for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open E-Tenders for the following works. The last date of online E-tendering is 18.03.2026 up to 15:00 hrs. All information and tender documents related to E-tender is available on website-www.ireps.gov.in.
Name of works : AT HJP & SEE :- Provision of Ballastless track at Line No. 1, 4 & 6 platform lines of Hajipur and line No. 3 & 6 in Sonpur. Approx Cost (In Rs.) ₹22,26,54,850.43. Earnest Money (In Rs.): ₹12,63,300/-
The above tender notice is available on website www.ireps.gov.in. **RIGHT OF RAILWAY TO DEAL WITH TENDER:** Railway Administration reserves the right to postpone/modify or to cancel any one or all the tenders without assigning any reasons.
Dy. Chief Project Manager
Gati Shakti/ECR/Sonpur
PR/1849/SEE/GS/Engg/T/25-26/32



EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE No. SG-664-17-Tele-2025-26
E-tender Is Invited on Behalf of The President Of India For The Under Mentioned Work:- (1) **Name of the work:** 1) Provision of Communication Media for working of Block, Axle Counter and other telecom circuits on wireless channel at Bukru Station (BUKR) 2) Shifting of MTRC subscribers working over Dhanbad division from NR (New Delhi) MSC to NFR MSC (Guwahati). 3) Provision of station VHF communication recording facility at different Stations over Dhanbad. (2) **Approx. Cost of the work:** Rs. 5,81,53,617.09 (3) **Earnest Money:** Rs. 4,40,800.00 (4) **Date & time for closing of tenders:** 23.03.2026 (12:00 Hrs) (5) **Any E-Tenders** which is sent by Post/ Courier/ FAX or self. Manual proposals although the letter is on firms letter pad or received in time will not be accepted. The above E-Tenders, E-Tendering document along with full information is available on website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in> Note :-Tenderers are requested to visit the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> atleast 10 days before last date of closing for latest corrigendum / corrections etc. in response to this E-tender.
Sr. D. S.T. E.
East Central Railway, Dhanbad.
PR/1839/DHN/S&T/T/25-26/36



VIT CHENNAI



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Building on the resounding success of its inaugural edition, The Hindu, in partnership with VIT School of Law, VIT Chennai, presents Justice Unplugged 2026, now convening in New Delhi, the nation's constitutional and legal epicentre.

The conclave addresses key questions, including the impact of Gen AI on legal practice, fundamental rights in the digital age, and improving access to justice, offering aspiring lawyers, law students and young legal professionals a rare opportunity to engage directly with distinguished leaders of the legal fraternity and gain valuable insights.

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CM YK

From Page One

‘PM’s frequent visits to T.N. will backfire on NDA’

“Even yesterday [February 24], the [Union] Cabinet approved a Metro Rail project for Gujarat, but nothing for Tamil Nadu. Even with the election approaching, nothing was allocated for the State in the Union Budget,” he said.

Describing the upcoming election as “Tamil Nadu vs NDA”, he said, “Tamil Nadu must be ruled from Fort St. George. A situation in which it is ruled from Delhi should not arise. The election is meant to decide that.”

He said the BJP wanted to defeat Tamil Nadu in every way. “What steps have been taken to protect Tamil Nadu’s fishermen? When will the arrest and assault of our fishermen by the Sri Lankan Navy end,” he asked. The BJP came to power at the Centre 12 years ago, promising that it would resolve the issue, he said, adding, “Who controls the External Affairs Ministry and the Navy?”

‘AIADMK a sinking ship’

Speaking about the AIADMK-BJP alliance, he said the AIADMK “is relying on a substandard engine called the BJP, and the BJP is relying on a sinking ship called the AIADMK”.

“The Dravidian model government is a super-fast engine, with a double-digit growth of 11.19%, and it is moving forward at a pace that no one could catch up with. We will be back with Dravidian Model 2.0, and in our second innings, we will surpass our own achievements,” Mr. Stalin said.

Ministers Mano Thangaraj, Geetha Jeevan, Anitha Radhakrishnan, and T.R.B. Rajaa; Kanniyakumari MP Vijay Vasanth; Congress MLAs S. Rajesh Kumar, J.G. Prince, and TharahaI Cuthbert; Tamil Nadu Food Commission Chairperson N. Suresh Rajan; and Nagercoil Mayor R. Mahesh were present at the function.

INBRIEF

Special security arrangements made ahead of PM Modi’s visit

The Greater Chennai City Police have stepped up security arrangements ahead of Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s visit to the city on February 28. The city police said areas around Meenambakkam and Guindy have been declared ‘Red Zones’, and the flying of drone cameras and unmanned aerial objects have been banned in these areas from February 28 to March 1 in view of the Prime Minister’s visit. The promulgation of orders under BNSS prohibiting the use of drones, remote-controlled micro-light aircraft, paragliders, paramotors, hot-air balloons etc., was already in force from February 19 to April 19 in the Greater Chennai Police limits.

Nallakannu will be accorded State honours for his contributions: CM

Stalin hails late CPI veteran’s role as a freedom fighter, social activist, and political leader; says he was ‘an uncompromising crusader of our times’; Prime Minister Narendra Modi and leaders from across the political spectrum condole his death

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Leaders from across the political spectrum condoled the death of Communist Party of India (CPI) veteran R. Nallakannu on Wednesday.

In a social media post, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said, “Thiru R. Nallakannu will be remembered for his grassroots connect and efforts to give voice to the underprivileged, workers and farmers. He was widely respected by people from every section of society. Equally noteworthy was his simplicity. My thoughts are with his family and admirers.”

Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha and Congress leader Rahul Gandhi said, “Comrade R. Nallakannu’s life was a rare example of integrity, simplicity, and unwavering commitment to the poor and the marginalised. For nearly nine decades, he stood firmly for justice and dignity. My heartfelt condolences to his family, colleagues, and countless admirers.”

Chief Minister M.K. Stalin said the Tamil Nadu government would accord full State honours to Mr. Nallakannu for his contributions to Tamil Nadu as well as India as a freedom fighter, a social activist, and a political leader.

In his condolence message, Mr. Stalin said the great life of the veteran leader was his message to the people. “Let it [the life of the late CPI leader] be our guiding light. The memory and fame of comrade R. Nallakannu, who lived his life for the proletarians, would remain in the minds of the people,” he said.

Recalling the veteran



Bidding adieu: Chief Minister M.K. Stalin paying his last respects to the mortal remains of CPI leader R. Nallakannu on Wednesday.

CPI leader’s association with former Chief Minister M. Karunanidhi, Mr. Stalin said Mr. Nallakannu was “an uncompromising crusader of our times. An eminent personality who spent much of his life for the country’s freedom struggle and for the working class”.

Mr. Nallakannu followed the path laid by late Communist leader Jeeva, Mr. Stalin said, adding that the CPI leader strongly held his principles at heart, and always had a smile on his face. The CPI leader worked with Karunanidhi on various issues, he said.

Mr. Stalin recalled that Karunanidhi had conferred the Ambedkar Award on the CPI leader during the erstwhile DMK government. “It was my honour to present the *Thaigaisai Thamizhar* Award to him under the Dravidian model government,” he said.

Mr. Stalin said Mr. Nallakannu shared a bond with him and welcomed the various welfare programmes of the DMK government.

“It is a matter of pride that we lived during his time. He was a great leader, who handed over any award or prize, along with the cash component, to

the government,” Mr. Stalin said.

Vice-President C.P. Radhakrishnan said he was pained by the death of Mr. Nallakannu, whom he described as a doyen of the Communist movement. He said the CPI veteran dedicated his life to workers’ rights and social justice. He was known for his integrity, simplicity and sacrifice, and his death was an irreparable loss, Mr. Radhakrishnan added.

A social media post by the Lok Bhavan quoted Governor R.N. Ravi as saying: “Deeply saddened by the passing away of veteran political leader Thiru R. Nallakannu. He dedicated his life to public service, with a spirit of simplicity and steadfast commitment. His demise leaves a void that will be deeply felt.”

‘Spearheaded protests’

Former Chief Minister and AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami said Mr. Nallakannu had late Chief Minister Jayalithaa’s affection. Mr. Nallakannu interacted with everyone with compassion, and led many protests to fulfil the just demands of labourers, he added.

Describing Mr. Nalla-

kannu as a great leader and a noble human being, MDMK general secretary Vaiko said he was an unparalleled leader in the Communist movement and a respected figure admired by all. He also recollected the life of Mr. Nallakannu and the livelihood struggles in which the late leader had participated.

CPI(M) State secretary P. Shanmugam said the death of Mr. Nallakannu was an irreparable loss to the Communist movement. He said CPI(M) flags would fly at half-mast across Tamil Nadu for three days.

Call for Bharat Ratna

VCK president Thol. Thirumavalavan described the late CPI leader as an epitome of ideological commitment. He urged the Centre to confer the Bharat Ratna on Mr. Nallakannu.

Tamil Nadu Congress Committee president K. Selvaperunthagai said the CPI veteran was a symbol of simplicity and honesty. He championed the rights of the labour class and worked tirelessly for their welfare, he said.

Union Minister of State for Information and Broadcasting L. Murugan said Mr. Nallakannu fought to eradicate untouchability and championed the cause of agricultural and industrial labourers.

BJP State president Nainar Nagenthran said Mr. Nallakannu entered politics at a very young age, dedicated his life to the freedom movement and fought for the rights of all sections of society. His public service and dedication will forever hold an indelible place in the hearts of the people and in the State’s history, Mr. Nagenthran added.

PMK leader Anbumani Ramadoss said Mr. Nallakannu worked for the welfare of the downtrodden and set an example for others to follow. He was a symbol of sacrifice and was respected by leaders from across the political spectrum.

AMMK general secretary T.T.V. Dhinakaran said Mr. Nallakannu stood as an exemplar in public life for sacrifice, service, integrity, and simplicity, and for having dedicated his entire life to the upliftment of the oppressed and farmers.

Tamil Maanila Congress (Moopanar) president G.K. Vasana said Mr. Nallakannu had dedicated more than eight decades of his life to public service. He also recollected Mr. Nallakannu’s association with his late father and Congress leader G.K. Moopanar. He said Mr. Nallakannu’s death was an irreparable loss to Tamil Nadu.

Makkal Needhi Maiam president Kamal Haasan said Mr. Nallakannu never thought about having a personal life, and dedicated his entire life for the betterment of society.

Actor Rajinikanth said Mr. Nallakannu stood steadfast in his ideological commitment, and his death was an irreparable loss to the people of Tamil Nadu.

Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam president Vijay said Mr. Nallakannu had spent most of his life fighting for the rights of the people.

Dravidar Kazhagam president K. Veeramani, Manithaneya Makkal Katchi leader M.H. Jawahirullah, and DMKD general secretary Premallatha Vijayakant also expressed their condolences over the death of Mr. Nallakannu.

No headway in seat-sharing talks between DMK, Cong.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The DMK has been unable to fix a date for holding seat-sharing talks with the Congress for the Tamil Nadu Assembly election, as the Congress leadership has refused to scale down the number of seats it has been demanding.

“All I can say is that the stalemate continues. The Congress wants 40 seats – one seat for each Lok Sabha constituency – a number that is impossible for us to accommodate,” a DMK source said.

Earlier, the DMK had asked the Congress leadership to be ready for talks on February 26 or 27. However, as of now, there is no confirmation of a date.

Chief Minister M.K. Stalin, who is in Kanniyakumari district to take part in various functions, is learnt to have told the local Congress MLAs – the district has three – that the DMK is under pressure to give seats to smaller parties that have joined its alliance.

In Kanniyakumari, where Christians form a core vote bank of the Congress-DMK alliance, there is growing concern over the lack of progress in talks between the two parties. Catholic and CSI Bishops, along with pastors of various denominations, have expressed apprehension over the development. A split in the DMK-Congress alliance, they feel, would benefit the AIADMK and the BJP, both of which are active in the district.

“It is not only about the Assembly election. A break-up will have far-reaching consequences in the Lok Sabha election too,” they have reportedly told the local Congress MLAs.

The Congress has also demanded two Rajya Sabha seats.

Political criticism that ruling party may even ‘give a wife to everyone’ is not misogynistic: Madras HC

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI



AIADMK Rajya Sabha member C.Ve. Shanmugam’s speech wherein he said the DMK government, which had been doling out cash gifts and other freebies, “may even give a wife to everyone”, cannot be termed misogynistic, the Madras High Court held on Wednesday.

Quashing the proceedings initiated against the Member of Parliament by the Tamil Nadu State Commission for Women (TNSCW), Justice A.D. Jagadish Chandira said the MP’s speech could, at best, be considered as a criticism of the government policy of giving away freebies, and not as a sexist comment aimed at demeaning women.

“Having gone through the petitioner’s aforesaid speech, this court is of the considered view that the same cannot be, by any stretch of imagination, construed to be misogynistic in nature or demeaning the womenfolk of the State as contended by the private respondents (the complainants),” the judge said.

He went on to state: “Instead, it can only be construed as a critique of the policy of giving freebies. Just because of the fact that the petitioner had stated that along with other commodities, the government may

announce even one wife free to each citizen, it can no way be inferred or understood that the petitioner, by his speech, has equated women with commodities given by the government gratis.”

Procedural violations

The judge also agreed with the MP’s counsel, M. Mohamed Riyaz, that the action initiated by the TNSCW suffered from procedural violations too, and hence, the Director General of Police (DGP) could not be allowed to proceed with the recommendation made by the commission for initiating criminal prosecution against the MP.

Justice Chandira pointed out that the TNSCW Act, 2008, requires the commission to conduct a detailed inquiry before arriving at a *prima facie* satisfaction with respect to the complaints received by it, and requires all orders and decisions taken by the commission to be authenticated by the Member Secretary.

Further, the Act makes

Instead, it [the MP’s speech] can only be construed as a critique of the policy of the government of giving freebies

JUSTICE A.D. JAGADISH
CHANDIRA
Madras High Court

it clear that the term, ‘commission’, would not refer to the chairperson alone, and that it would include the five members as well. However, in the instant case, all proceedings initiated against the MP had been signed only by the chairperson and not authenticated by the Member Secretary, he said.

“In such perspective of the matter, this court unhesitatingly holds that the proceedings initiated by the Chairperson against the petitioner, including the communication dated November 11, 2025, addressed to the second respondent (DGP), cannot be sustained in the eyes of law,” the judge said.

He also pointed out that the TNSCW had not conduct any inquiry before recommending criminal prosecution, and it had not even served upon the MP a copy of the complaint it had received from All India Democratic Women’s Association State president G. Pramila and secretary A. Radhika regarding the speech.

CPI(M) leader doubts AIADMK’s role in NDA seat-sharing talks

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Communist Party of India (Marxist) State secretary P. Shanmugam on Wednesday said it appeared that the BJP would allocate seats to the AIADMK and not the other way around in the NDA alliance.

In a post on X, he said AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami had been saying that his party was leading the NDA in Tamil Nadu. However, some NDA constituents had indicated that they would hold seat-sharing talks only with the BJP, a

claim that the national party had not denied, he added.

“In such a scenario, it appears that only the BJP would allocate seats to the AIADMK. It is time for the followers of Jayalithaa, who once asked, ‘Modi or Lady’, to think about this,” he said.

He was referring to the slogan raised by the former Chief Minister during the 2014 Lok Sabha election, when she said, “Who is a better administrator? Is it Gujarat’s Modi [Narendra Modi was then Gujarat Chief Minister] or this Tamil Nadu lady?”

Palaniswami hits back at Stalin, says DMK is a ‘slave’ of Congress

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami on Wednesday accused the ruling DMK of being a “slave” of the Congress.

Rebutting Chief Minister and DMK president M.K. Stalin’s criticism that he was a “slave of Delhi” (meaning the BJP-led government at the Centre), Mr. Palaniswami told a gathering at Vanagaram near Chennai: “We have never been slaves of anyone. We believe in our constructive work. By implementing [welfare] projects, we had secured the support [of the Centre].

He was responding to CM’s remark that the AIADMK leader was a ‘slave of Delhi’

But your party is not like us. The Congress had secured seats by intimidating the DMK.”

Referring to reports of differences between the DMK and the Congress over sharing of seats, the AIADMK leader said his organisation had formed an alliance with like-minded parties. “The alliance will bag the largest number of seats and the AIADMK will form the government,” he said, adding that the AIADMK had struck an al-

liance with the BJP “only to remove the DMK from power”.

As for CPI(M) State secretary P. Shanmugam’s remark that it appeared that the BJP would allocate seats to the AIADMK in the upcoming election, he said the CPI(M) had not grown in the State because it had been a “slave” [of the DMK] for about 10 years.

Comparing the prices of essential commodities under AIADMK and DMK rule, he said the ruling party had not taken steps to contain inflation.

During the day, Mr. Palaniswami covered the Poonamallee and Maduravoyal constituencies.

High Court confirms acquittal of Veerappan’s suspected aides in Kannada actor Rajkumar’s abduction case

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

The Madras High Court on Wednesday dismissed a State appeal preferred in 2019 against the 2018 acquittal of nine individuals, suspected of being members of forest brigand Veerappan’s gang, which abducted Kannada actor Rajkumar on July 30, 2000 and held him hostage for 108 days.

A Division Bench of Justices P. Velmurugan and M. Jothiraman confirmed the



Forest brigand Veerappan with Kannada actor Rajkumar. FILE PHOTO

order of acquittal passed by the third Additional District and Sessions Court at Gobichettipalayam in Erode district on September 25, 2018 and held that

it did not find any reason to interfere with the well-reasoned trial court verdict.

In his verdict, the sessions judge K. Mani had pointed out that the FIR re-

garding the abduction was registered about 24 hours after the incident, and that too on the basis of a complaint lodged by Village Administrative Officer (VAO) Gopal, who was not an eyewitness to the incident.

The VAO had claimed to have gained knowledge about the incident only through the general public, though according to the prosecution, Rajkumar and three others were abducted from his ancestral farm house at Gajanur village in Thalavady Taluk of

Erode district in the presence of many others.

Further, the date in the FIR had been corrected from July 30, 2000 to July 31, 2000, and it had no mention of any criminal conspiracy having been hatched by the accused to abduct the actor.

The trial court had listed several other infirmities in the prosecution case before deciding to acquit all nine individuals of the charges of attempt to murder, possession of arms, and so on.

INBRIEF



Rahul to lay foundation stone for landslide victims' homes

Rahul Gandhi, Leader of the Opposition in Lok Sabha, is scheduled to lay the foundation stone for the new houses to be built by the Congress for the survivors of the 2024 Mundakkai-Chooramala landslide in Wayanad, Kerala, on Thursday. Congress leader Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, MP, will be present at the event at Kalpetta. The event has been scheduled for 2.30 p.m. A release said that Mr. Gandhi will land on Thursday morning at the Kannur airport.

Peace meet held after Dalit couple denied temple entry

A day after an agriculturist from Tumakuru district in Karnataka was arrested for preventing a newly-wed Dalit couple from entering a temple on February 19, the district administration convened a peace meeting and escorted the newly-wed couple to perform puja. A peace meeting was convened in Goni village of Turuvekere taluk following alleged humiliation of a newly-wed Dalit couple who were asked to leave the Arasamma Devi temple.

Street dog bites nine-year-old boy on face in Vijayawada

A nine-year-old boy suffered serious injuries after a street dog bit him on his face at One Town in Vijayawada, Andhra Pradesh, on Tuesday. The boy had accidentally fell on the dog after losing balance on his bicycle, CCTV footage showed. Doctors reportedly said the child needed two more days of observation. As per B. Somasekhara Reddy, Veterinary Assistant Surgeon, Vijayawada Municipal Corporation, the dog that attacked the boy was recently sterilised and vaccinated.

Kerala Minister injured in scuffle; CPI(M) launches stir

The episode occurred amid protests against the Health Minister by KSU activists at Kannur railway station; she has been admitted to a hospital where a team of experts will assess her condition

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Protests by the Communist Party of India (Marxist) and its affiliate groups erupted across Kerala after Health Minister Veena George sustained injuries to her neck and hand during a scuffle between black-flag-wielding Kerala Students Union (KSU) activists and the police at the Kannur railway station on Wednesday.

The Minister, who was scheduled to leave for Thiruvananthapuram, was admitted to the ICU of the Kannur District Hospital. A medical bulletin from the



Chaotic chapter: Police officers shield Veena George during the KSU protest at the Kannur railway station on Wednesday. S.K. MOHAN

hospital stated that an expert team had been assigned to assess the severity of the Minister's neck injury.

The police arrested five KSU workers over the incident and charged them with attempted murder.

The episode occurred amid widespread protests against the Minister by the Opposition in recent days, who have alleged a collapse of the public health sector. It sparked strong reactions and protest

marches by Leftist and Left-leaning outfits across the State, leading to effigy-burning and confrontations with Congress workers.

Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan visited Ms. George at the hospital and described the incident as "a heinous attack" on a woman holding public office. "The incident reflects the inherent villainy of the Congress leadership," he said. He said Kerala's public health system was renowned and had emerged as the best in the country, according to surveys and audits by various agencies, including the NITI Aayog.

A.P. diarrhoea outbreak leaves 1 dead

Harish Gilai
SRIKAKULAM/VISAKHAPATNAM

Srikakulam district in Andhra Pradesh is on high alert after the death of a 43-year-old man and the hospitalisation of 76 others owing to a diarrhoea outbreak reportedly caused by contaminated drinking water.

Among those hospitalised, two elderly patients are critical.

The district administration has suspended municipal water supply to the affected neighbourhoods and has intensified sanitation measures in these areas. Medical camps have been set up at two loca-



Srikakulam Collector Swapnil Dinkar Pundkar visits a patient at a hospital in Srikakulam.

tions, and three ambulances are on standby. A door-to-door survey has also begun to assess the health condition of the residents.

The incident came to light on Monday, when a

few patients were admitted to hospitals with diarrhoea. The number of cases gradually rose by Tuesday, and the death on Tuesday triggered panic among the residents.

Gondur Shankar, MLA, and District Collector Swapnil Dinkar Pundkar visited the family of the deceased and handed over a cheque for ₹10 lakh.

The residents blamed the outbreak on water contamination, and alleged that in certain areas, municipal water pipelines ran close to or intersected drainage canals. They said they noticed a change in the colour of the water

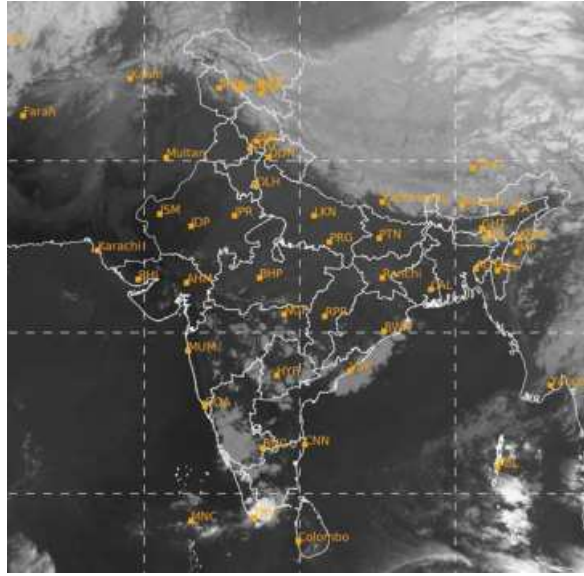
supplied on Saturday and Sunday. There was a foul smell too, they said.

The Collector said water samples were collected from six locations and sent to the Water Testing Laboratory in Srikakulam. The initial reports indicated no contamination. However, he noted that additional biological and chemical analysis reports from samples sent to Visakhapatnam were still awaited.

Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu on Wednesday reviewed the situation following the diarrhoea outbreak and the reported milk contamination in Rajamahendravaram.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Thursday: Thunderstorm accompanied with lightning/gusty winds likely at isolated places over Telangana, north interior Karnataka and Andaman & Nicobar Islands

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala		31.2	17.8	Kozhikode		13	34.0
Ahmedabad		36.4	21.8	Kurnool		36.0	21.7
Aizawl		28.6	16.9	Lucknow		30.4	15.4
Allahabad		30.8	14.0	Madurai		35.0	24.0
Bengaluru		31.6	19.9	Mangaluru		32.0	24.5
Bhopal		30.6	13.8	Mumbai		32.1	20.3
Bhubaneswar		33.3	18.8	Mysuru		33.0	19.0
Chandigarh		27.8	13.3	New Delhi		30.2	12.6
Chennai		31.8	24.3	Patna		29.0	18.5
Coimbatore		34.0	23.2	Port Blair		5	31.2
Dehradun		27.7	12.4	Puducherry		31.4	23.2
Gangtok		16.6	8.1	Pune		36.3	20.1
Goa		33.6	24.0	Raipur		33.1	19.8
Guwahati		31.1	15.7	Ranchi		27.0	13.2
Hubballi		33.0	20.0	Shillong		19.0	9.8
Hyderabad		32.6	20.9	Shimla		20.6	9.0
Imphal		27.6	11.1	Srinagar		20.8	1.5
Jaipur		30.8	18.2	Thiruvananthapuram		33.8	25.2
Kochi		19	31.4	Tiruchi		34.1	23.0
Kohima		20.0	11.4	Vijayawada		33.6	22.0
Kolkata		30.8	20.0	Visakhapatnam		32.0	24.3

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad		113	51		223		In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Agartala,
Bengaluru		31	16		122		Tripura recorded an
Chennai		14	55		46		overall air quality index
Delhi		91	97		279		(AQI) score of 356
Hyderabad		8	45		74		indicating an unhealthy
Kolkata		97	35		120		level of pollution. In
Lucknow		11	28		233		contrast, Naharlagun,
Mumbai		72		105			Arunachal Pradesh
Pune		123	79		134		recorded a healthy AQI
Visakhapatnam		18					score of 17

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM-2
E-Tender No. 100-SNT-Proj-Tender-2026, Date: 20.12.2025
Corrigendum No.-2: In above tender, corrigendum no. 2 issued on 16.02.2026. No change is made in the closing date of tender in Corrigendum 2.
For further details/purchase of tender document, eligibility criteria & the complete details for 'E' tender document, please contact our website <https://www.ireps.gov.in>.
Dy. Chief Sgn. & Tele. Engg. (Project-II) CPR/10/712 S.E.C.Railway, Bilaspur
South East Central Railway @secrail

TAMIL NADU POLICE HOUSING CORPORATION LTD
(A Government of Tamil Nadu undertaking)
(ISO 9001 : 2015 CERTIFIED COMPANY)
No.132, E.V.R. Salai, Kilpauk, Chennai - 600 010.
Short Term e-TENDER-INVITATION FOR BIDS NO.37/2025-26 Dt:24.02.2026

Sl. No.	Name of work	App.Valu Rs.In Lakhs	Sale period	Opening
1.	Providing Structural Glazing and Aluminium Composite Panel for the work of Construction of Cyber Crime Administrative Office Building at PTC Campus, Ashok Nagar in Chennai city. (SE/CC/DB/241-A/2026)	₹85.70 + GST @ 18%	02.03.2026 to 07.03.2026	09.03.2026
2.	Providing CCTV, Data Cable arrangements, Telephone System for the work of Construction of Cyber Crime Administrative Office Building at PTC Campus, Ashok Nagar in Chennai city. (SE/CC/DB/241-C/2026)	₹57.62 + GST @ 18%		

For other details visit <http://tntenders.gov.in> and TNPHC website www.tnphc.com
DIPR/1379/TENDER/2026 Superintending Engineer / CC TNPHC Ltd., Chennai.

TAMIL NADU HOUSING BOARD
PROJECT CIRCLE (RURAL)
(Superintending Engineer, Project Circle (Rural), Tamil Nadu Housing Board, 485, MTB Building, IInd Floor, Anna Salai, Nandanam, Chennai - 35) E-mail: sespc1@gmail.com, Ph: 044-24353544
e-Tender Notice No: SE/PC(R)/08/2025-26 Date:24.02.2026

Name of Work	Approximate Value of work (Incl. GST @ 18%)
Construction of Compound wall with barbed wire fencing protection and metal sheet fencing to the 1848 MSB TNGRHS (Stilt+14 Floors) at Kavundampalayam Village, Coimbatore District.	Rs.85.74 Lakh

1. For Tender document visit <https://tntenders.gov.in> Date and Time for downloading and submission of tender documents: From 27.02.2026 - 11.00 AM to 16.03.2026 - 11.00 AM
2. Date and Time of opening of the e-Tender: 16.03.2026 - 12.30 PM
3. Detailed Tender Notice is available in the website : <https://tntenders.gov.in>.
DIPR/1348/TENDER/2026 Superintending Engineer, Project Circle (Rural)/TNHB

Tamil Nadu Power Generation Corporation Ltd
Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
178	SE / MM-II / NCTPS-I	Procurement Erection Testing and Commissioning of New Inergen IG 541 fire suppression system of Unit

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / Opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit websites: www.tenders.tn.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in
DIPR/1400/Tender/2026

Tamil Nadu Power Generation Corporation Ltd
Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
149	SE / MM-II / NCTPS-I	NCTPS I SE M II Circle AHP Dn Unit I II III O and M PDFACS period of 90 days or Quantity 78000 MT
150	SE / MM-II / NCTPS-I	NCTPS I SE M II Circle AHP Dn Unit I II III Operation and Maintenance PDFACS for a period one year
262	SE / MM-II / NCTPS-II	NCTPS II M Circle CA RODM Replacement Strengthening of deteriorated
280	SE / MM-II / NCTPS-II	NCTPS II M Circle BM Division 600 MW Unit II Boiler attending Boiler tube puncture and up keeping
301	SE / P&A / NCTPS-II	PROCUREMENT OF 219 1 OD and 273 MM OD SEAMLESS PIPES WITH SUITABLE M S FLANGES
312	SE / P&A / NCTPS-II	supply of spool piece pipe with flanged in one end and a loose flange at other end
239	CE / MTPS-I	Dragging out the floor ash under B Pass of ESP by using the Front End Bar Loader
240	CE / MTPS-I	Dragging out the floor ash under C Pass of ESP by using the Front End Bar Loader
241	CE / MTPS-I	Dragging out the floor ash under D Pass of ESP by using the Front End Bar Loader
238	CE / MTPS-I	Dragging out the floor ash under A Pass of ESP by using the Front End Bar Loader

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / Opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit websites: www.tenders.tn.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in
DIPR/1412/Tender/2026

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
RCD, ROAD DIVISION, JAMSHEDPUR, JHARKHAND

e-Procurement Notice
For National Competitive Bidding

e-Tender Reference No. RCD/JAMSHEDPUR/356, Date-18.02.2026

1.	Name of the work	Reconstruction of Manushmudia of Bahragora to Darishol Chowk Road for year 2025-26. Total Length- 10.274 km
2.	Estimated Cost of Work (in INR)	Rs 37,03,07,800.86 (Rupees Thirty Seven Crore Three Lakh Seven Thousand Eight Hundred and Paise Eighty Six Only)
3.	Initial Bid Security (Rs In Lacs)	Rs 37.04 Lakh (Rupees Thirty Seven Lakh Four Thousand only).
4.	Initial Bid Security in the shape of	Initial Bid Security - As per SOP issued by Information Technology and e-Governance Department, Govt. of Jharkhand vide Letter No.120, Dt. 03.10.2023
5.	Cost of Bidding documents	Rs 10,000.00 (Rs Ten Thousand) only.
6.	Time of Completion	12 (Twelve Months)
7.	Date of Publication of Tender on website	23.02.2026 at 12.30 P.M.
8.	Start date of bidding	23.02.2026 from 12.30 P.M.
9.	Last date & Time for online bidding	19.03.2026 up to 02.00 P.M.
10.	Type of Bid	Two envelope mode (Technical and Financial Bid)
11.	Last date & time for receipt of Bid Security and other documents in Online form	19.03.2026 Through e-tendering portal www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in As per SOP issued by Information Technology and e-Governance Department, Govt. of Jharkhand vide Letter No.120, Dt. 03.10.2023
12.	Date & time for opening of Technical Bid	20.03.2026 at 3.30 PM by Chairman e-Procurement Cell, Room No. 330 A, 3 rd Floor, Road Construction Department, Jharkhand Mantralaya, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004.
13.	Date & Time of Pre Bid Meeting	05.03.2026 on 12.30 P.M. At Office of the Chief Engineer (Communication), Road Construction Department, Engineers Hostel No.2, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004
14.	Name & address of office inviting tender	Executive Engineer, RCD, Road Division, Jamshedpur, Road No.- 1, CH Area. 0657-2227724
15.	Contact no. of Procurement officer	
16.	Helpline number of e-Procurement cell	0651-2401010

Above informations are only indicative. Detail NIT & SBD published on Tender portal shall be final and mandatory. Details can be seen on website <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>

Superintending Engineer - cum - Executive Engineer RCD, Road Division, Jamshedpur
PR 373598 Road(25-26)#D

THE HINDU Youngworld
TREASURE IN YOUR HANDS

Women's Day Special Issue

INSIDE THIS ISSUE

- Timeline of Women's Rights Movement
- First Indian Woman to...
- How you can celebrate Women's Day
- Women inventors
- Student reflections on the woman who inspired them and the impact she had on their lives.
- Activity sheet

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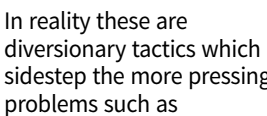
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Decolonising and de-Nobelising science

Every February 28, India celebrates National Science Day to commemorate C.V. Raman's announcement of the Raman effect in 1928, a discovery that won him the Nobel Prize in Physics in 1930. Such national rituals are said to be just acts of remembrance, but they are not; they also legitimise what the state says counts as science.

Three keywords
A new book about keywords offers a useful way to read this ritual itself as a word with a political life. *Decolonial Keywords*, edited by anthropologists Renny Thomas and Sasanka Perera, argues that some everyday terms can be treated as archives of history and power and that their definitions are often a political rather than a linguistic achievement. 'National Science Day' and 'Nobel Prize' can also be treated as such keywords: ones that organise India's public imagination of science. There is a reason we mark a date that can be narrated with a "world-class discovery" rather than a date on which, say, a public hospital improved maternal outcomes. If decolonising science is to mean anything in India, it must include the need to de-Nobelise how the state understands and valorises science. Specifically, it must stop treating external prestige as the main proof of scientific worth and expand the cast of legitimate scientific actors and sites. Three keywords from the book – 'jugaad', 'poromboke', and 'laboratory' – help show how this recognition works through institutional infrastructures. Researcher and author Pankaj Sekhsaria's essay on 'jugaad' begins by using the word's instability – it can plausibly be read as a virtue, a compromise, or corruption – to explain how it creates space for powerful actors to amplify the meanings that suit them and discard those that don't. He also shows how the word has been absorbed into managerial talk as a laudable synonym for frugal innovation while other



Vasudevan Mukunth

National Science Day should not just reproduce a story about genius and external validation. It should become an annual day of discussion of what counts as science, including the work of field staff, nurses, and others

resonances remain harder to hear or take seriously. This is how innovation tends to behave in the public theatre of National Science Day. It becomes a stage-managed synonym for ingenuity that the stage packages for elite consumption, preferably in English, preferably legible to global management culture, and preferably compatible with award narratives. Prof. Sekhsaria ends with a question that cuts through this template: what words do farmers, fishers, and craftspeople use to describe their own inventiveness? Answering this question forces our attention away from the elite markers of prestige and towards the vocabularies that people use to produce and name practical knowledge. Professor Banu Subramaniam's chapter on 'poromboke' makes a parallel argument about classification, anchored in Tamil political ecology. The state often glosses over 'poromboke' as wasteland, or land that does not generate revenue for the state. Her point is that the revenue category has always been a social category in disguise because the state's accounting decides which landscapes count as productive and so which people's uses count as legitimate. Historically, the term also referred to land set aside for public use, whereas in contemporary practice it covers a range of commons that remain essential for marginalised communities precisely because they are not private property. She also remarks on how the word has become a pejorative in common Tamil speech, meaning 'good for nothing'. When the state declares a landscape to be disposable, the people who depend on it become easier to declare disposable as well. In the same way, some kinds of inquiry are said to be 'national science' while others of less prestige are rendered 'routine work' or 'local practice'. This is why what we celebrate on National Science Day is not value-neutral but a way to sort the labour of science. Dr. Thomas focuses on

'laboratory' and his analysis begins by distinguishing between elite 'mega labs' and the 'minor labs' ubiquitous in towns and villages, especially diagnostic centres ('pathology labs'). Raman's own story is inseparable from laboratory infrastructure – he announced the Raman effect while working at the Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science in Calcutta – but Dr. Thomas's point is that this recognisability is something we manufacture. When schools teach the laboratory as the place where great people work in isolation, the everyday diagnostic lab, where most Indians actually encounter scientific authority, becomes conceptually minor even though it is central to society. And once we treat a 'lab' as a social institution, its politics become part of its definition. Dr. Thomas has found in his own work that lab-mates do science but also share rituals, gossip, and celebrate occasions together, and is often a space where people reproduce hierarchies of caste and gender. But in other settings, it is also a place where the authority of 'science' is routinely performed before the public.

What counts as science
The keywords thus clarify what a de-Nobelised imagination of science, paralleling the decolonisation of science, would require. It would force India to ask how Indians produce the thing called 'recognition' – through discoveries and papers as much as by institutions that sort labour into celebrated and hidden. National Science Day, then, should not simply reproduce a Nobel-shaped story about genius and external validation. It should become an annual day of discussion of what counts as science, including the work of technicians, field staff, nurses, lab attendants, data collectors, and others whose labour is essential to make new knowledge but is rarely commemorated.

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The BJP's West Bengal gamble

Its strategy hinges on polarisation and support from former Left adherents

STATE OF PLAY

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For a party that won just three Assembly seats in 2016 to being the principle Opposition in the West Bengal Assembly in 2021 with 77 seats, the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) has come a long way. Yet, according to senior party strategists, it still needs to identify its electoral base – not just the hard-core Sangh Parivar cohort, but also the anti-Trinamool Congress and Left Front voters, who cast their votes strategically. As the BJP settles down to chart out a strategy for the upcoming Assembly elections, two approaches are gaining traction. The first seeks to appeal to Sangh Parivar-aligned voters and the second seeks to attract an anti-Trinamool and largely Left Front voter base. The first approach focuses on polarisation, framed around the narrative of infiltration from Bangladesh. This promotes the idea that a porous border facilitates such movement and that the State government is not willing to cooperate with the Centre in controlling it as it wants support from minority voters. This narrative is particularly popular in districts along the porous India-Bangladesh border, including parts of North Bengal and stretches of South and Central Bengal. And the recently concluded general elections in Bangladesh have helped bolster it. While the Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP) won the elections with 212 seats and promised to protect minority Hindus, the Bangladesh Jamaat-e-Islami (Jel) party-led coalition won 77 out of the 300 seats in Parliament, with the Jel itself winning a record

68 seats, making it the principle opposition party. Many of the Jel's seats are concentrated in the border regions, including the Khulna division. For the BJP, this fact adds weight to its narrative of infiltration and changing demographics in these areas, which will help polarise the electorate in its favour. The BJP performed well in the 2019 Lok Sabha polls in these regions, but did not perform as well in the 2021 Assembly elections. The second point gaining traction is the party's realisation of which voters drove its surge in the 2019 Lok Sabha and 2021 Assembly polls. They were, surprisingly, largely former Left Front supporters. In the 2016 Assembly elections, the Left-Congress alliance received a vote share of 38.1% and a seat share of 77. The BJP secured only 10.2% of the vote share and three seats. In the 2021 Assembly elections, the BJP's vote share increased significantly to 38.1%. It won 77 seats – the same number that the Left-Congress alliance had won in 2016. This showed that most of the anti-Trinamool Congress voters had shifted to the BJP. What is more significant is that in the 2019 Lok Sabha polls, the BJP got 18 seats and 40.2% of the vote share, which, if extrapolated to Assembly segments, translated into dominance in 121 of them. Yet, the 2021 Assembly elections showed that some of the anti-Trinamool votes that had

gone to the BJP in the Lok Sabha polls returned to the Left-Congress alliance. Recovering the vote share to the 2019 levels is part of the BJP's strategy now. For example, in around 49 seats in the Greater Kolkata area where the BJP routinely performs poorly, the Left retained second place in several seats and held on to portions of its vote. BJP backroom strategists are now reaching out to local Left supporters, trying to convince them that, in the absence of a Left-Congress alliance, the only way to defeat the Trinamool is to consolidate their votes behind the BJP more than they did in the past. The party is using the anti-incumbency narrative against the three-term Trinamool Congress government, to convince floating voters, not aligned at any level with the BJP, that the national party is their best bet to vote out the Trinamool government. This is what West Bengal BJP president Samik Bhattacharya said when he took over the post in July last year: "Leave all ideologies aside and come together to remove Trinamool from power. Then you can raise your flag and find your own path again. There will be a space for Opposition." An election campaign and strategy involves many moving parts – a patchwork of narratives, demographics, and arithmetic. Winning over voters from an ideological rival to strategically block a third, more dominant force is not a new tactic, but it comes with challenges. It requires psychological operations and a covert communications strategy, which often fail. Yet, if executed well, this complex strategy can make even seemingly impossible outcomes possible. And that is precisely what the BJP hopes to achieve successfully in West Bengal.

Modi's Israel visit: Balancing ties amid West Bank tensions

The Prime Minister's visit to Israel comes after India aligned with more than 100 countries at the UN in criticising Israel's moves in the West Bank

DATA POINT

Devvyanshi Bihani

Prime Minister Narendra Modi landed in Israel on Wednesday to discuss with his counterpart Benjamin Netanyahu a range of issues aimed at boosting bilateral ties, and key developments in the region. His earlier visit to Israel in 2017 was the first by any Indian Prime Minister. The visit comes shortly after India aligned with more than 100 countries at the United Nations in criticising Israel's moves in the West Bank. It signed a joint statement after initially staying away from a collective condemnation of settlement expansion. India and Israel established full diplomatic relations in 1992. The relationship has deepened significantly over the past decade across defence, trade, technology and labour mobility. **Chart 1** shows trends in India-Israel bilateral trade from 2015-16 to 2024-25. From about \$200 million in 1992, bilateral trade has expanded significantly, peaking at over \$10.7 billion in 2022-23. It declined to \$6.5 billion in 2023-24 and further to \$3.6 billion in 2024-25 due to war-related disruptions and trouble in the trade route. Since 2014-15, India has maintained a trade surplus with Israel. The surplus widened sharply to \$6.1 billion in 2022-23, before narrowing to \$2.5 billion in 2023-24 and further down to \$663 million in 2024-25. **Charts 2A and 2B** show India's top five exports to Israel and imports from it. Each commodity's share in total imports and exports based on cumulative values from 2019-2025 is mentioned. In the 2019-2025 period, refined products made from crude oil such as petrol and diesel accounted for nearly 44% of India's exports to Israel, followed by diamonds at about 22%. Diamonds dominated imports too, making

up about a third of India's total imports from Israel. Diamonds are imported as rough stones from Israel, cut and polished in India, and then exported back as finished products. Mineral or chemical fertilizers, electronic integrated circuits and radar apparatus are also significant imports from Israel. Defense cooperation remains the cornerstone of the India-Israel strategic partnership. **Chart 3** shows India's share in Israel's arms exports from 1997-2024. India accounted for over 38% of Israel's arms exports between 2014 and 2024. Over the past decade, India has emerged as one of the largest importers of Israel's arms and ammunitions. According to data from the Stockholm International Peace Research Institute, India accounted for over 38% of Israel's arms exports between 2014 and 2024. Israel's cumulative foreign direct investment into India crossed \$347 million between 2000 and September 2025, according to government data. Israel has made over 300 investments in India, mainly in the technology domain. Indian companies too have invested in Israeli technology firms, particularly in the cybersecurity, agriculture, water management, and electric mobility sectors. The cumulative overseas direct investment from India between April 2000 and April 2025 was \$443 million. The partnership also aligns with the 'Make in India' push, with Israeli firms increasingly collaborating with Indian companies to manufacture equipment locally. Another key dimension of the relationship is migration and mobility. As of 2024, around 32,715 Indians travelled to Israel, up from about 27,196 in 2023. A significant portion of this movement is linked to employment. Official data show that there were around 32,000 Indian workers in Israel as of October 2024, many of whom were recruited after the outbreak of the Gaza conflict to replace Palestinian labour in the construction sector. There are also about 900 Indian students studying in Israel.

Walking a tightrope

The data were sourced from the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, the Stockholm International Peace Research Institute (SIPRI), the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade, the Ministry of External Affairs, and the Lok Sabha



CHART 1: Trends in India-Israel bilateral trade from 2015-16 to 2024-25 (in \$ billion)

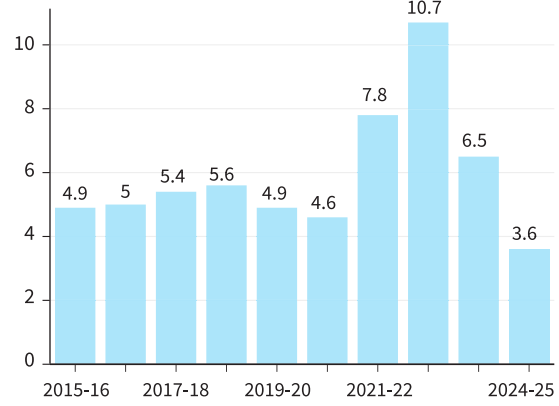


CHART 3: India's share in Israel's arms exports from 1997 to 2024 in %. India has emerged as one of the largest importers of Israel's arms and ammunitions

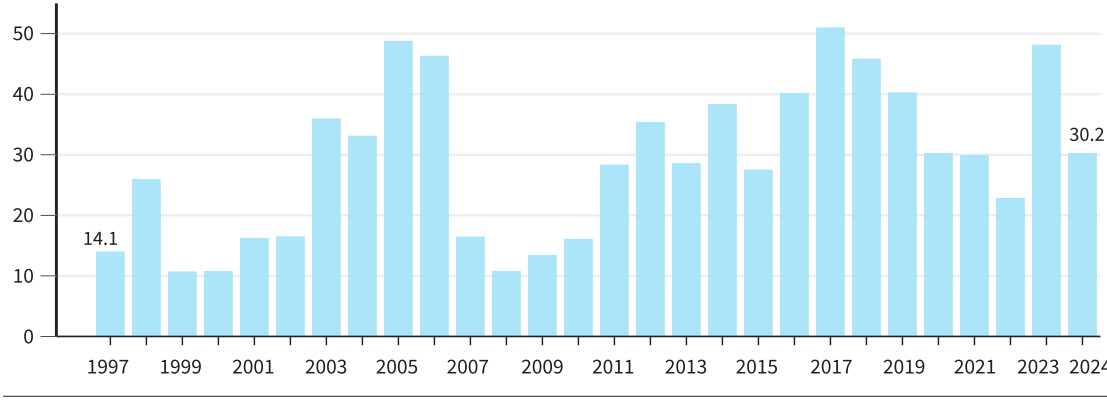


CHART 2A: India's top five exports to Israel and each commodity's share in total exports

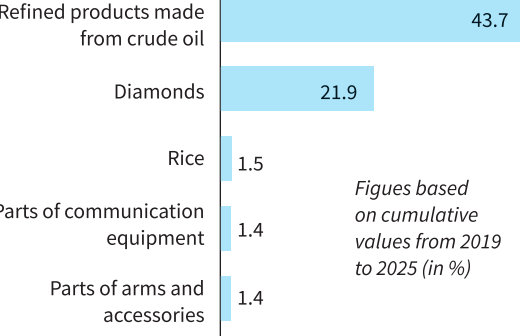
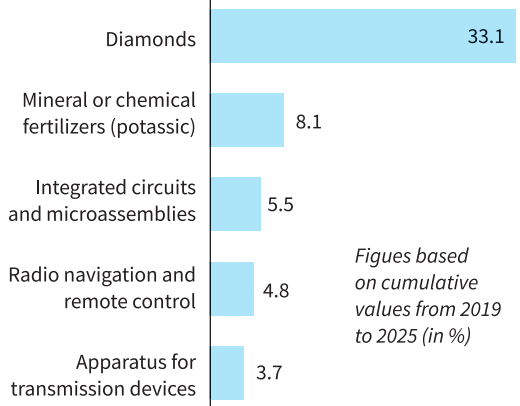


CHART 2B: India's top five imports from Israel and each commodity's share in total imports



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO FEBRUARY 26, 1976

Noise pollution in Madras: study findings

Madras, Feb. 25: A pilot study on "noise pollution", conducted in four selected areas in Madras during peak hours, shows that the intensity of sound level is "highly irritating and uncomfortable" opposite the Anna Salai Post Office. However, the intensity of sound (73 decibels) registered in the areas falls well within the damaging noise level (85 decibels) and is lower than what is obtaining in other major cities like Bombay, Calcutta and Delhi. Frequent honring and engine vibrations, especially of motorcycles and scooters, are the loud irritants outside the Anna Salai Post Office. The area near the Central Station and the General Hospital comes second with 71 decibels, the Kothwal Market area third with 70 decibels and the Parry's Corner fourth with no decibels. The study is part of a noise pollution survey in different parts of Madras, Madurai, Coimbatore, Trivandrum, Cochin, Mysore and Bangalore, sponsored by the Department of Science and Technology of the Union Government. A team of ENT specialists and audiologists of the Institute of Oto-Rhino Laryngology at the Madras Medical College and engineers of the IIT, which conducted the study with the help of sophisticated sound level meters and analysers and by interviewing the people, has expressed the view that unless the increasing noise pollution was checked, the continuous exposure of the residents in the area for a prolonged period may end in permanent irreversible hearing loss.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO FEBRUARY 26, 1926

Malaria in Bombay

Bombay, Jan. 25: A sub-committee appointed by the Corporation have recommended drastic measures for combating malaria. They suggest the doing away with open roadside drains which should be replaced by underground stormwater pipes, the covering up of the stormwater pipes and tanks of mills rendering wells mosquito proof and filling in the low-lying lands in the city. The railway companies ought to be called upon to fill in the low-lying lands on either side of the railway lines within the railway limit and neither the Government nor anyone else be exempted from statutory obligation and liabilities, enforceable under the Municipal Law in matters affecting the health of the city.

M CH-CHE

Mamata says names of 1.2 cr. voters may be deleted after SIR

The Hindu Bureau
KOLKATA

West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee on Wednesday expressed concern that the names of about 1.2 crore voters may be deleted following the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in the State. The final rolls are likely to be published on Saturday.

“In the first phase, 58 lakh names were excluded. Then they are secretly excluding [more] people again in the name of logical discrepancy. It will be 80 lakh, not 50 lakh. If we assume that 20 lakh voters have died, then the names of about 1.2 crore people will be excluded from the voter list,” the Chief Minister said.

Speaking at an event in her Assembly constituency, Bhabanipur, Ms. Banerjee said that she had fought against the SIR exercise in the Supreme Court.

“I myself went and fought in the Supreme Court. The petition is still pending. Many days have passed since the court’s order. I don’t know what will happen to the list that will



Mamata Banerjee

be published on the February 28,” she said.

The Trinamool Congress chairperson said that she would pray for those whose names might be deleted from the electoral rolls. Addressing members of the Jain community at the event, she said that her concerns were not about religious or political affiliations of the party.

“I am for humanity. It does not matter who is Trinamool, who is BJP, who is CPM. Who is Hindu, who is Muslim, who is Sikh, who is Jain, who is Christian. I just want to ensure that democracy in the country is protected and the rights of every citizen are upheld,” she said.

Class 10 admit cards can be used in Bengal SIR: SC

Voters can submit the cards and pass certificates as they show details of both birth, parentage, Bench tells EC; the court had expanded judicial team on Tuesday to help speed up the process

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Wednesday clarified that the *Madhyamik* (Class 10) admit card may be submitted along with the *Madhyamik* pass certificate as proof of birth and parentage by electors during the verification of their claims and objections in the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in West Bengal.

A three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant directed that verification documents which have not been uploaded so far, and received before February 14, should be submitted by the Election Registration Officers or Assistant Election Registration Officers by 5 p.m. on Thursday.

Justice Joymalya Bagchi, on the Bench, told the Election Commission that the *Madhyamik* admit cards in West Bengal comprehensively showed details of both birth and pa-



Document verification: People waiting in a queue for special intensive revision hearings in Nadia, West Bengal. PTI

rentage. The EC had sought the clarification in an oral mentioning.

Court intervention

The Supreme Court on February 20 had taken the “extraordinary” decision to involve the judiciary in the SIR exercise in Bengal, pointing to the persistent “trust deficit” between the Mamata Banerjee government and the EC, which had led to a “stalemate”.

The court had on that day requested the Chief

Justice of the Calcutta High Court to deploy a force of serving and retired judicial officers of “impeccable integrity” in West Bengal to take over the quasi-judicial task of EROs and AEROs.

They would be hearing lakhs of voters who found themselves purged from the West Bengal draft roll, and had received hearing notices after the poll panel found them “unmapped” or detected “logical discrepancies” in their personal details. Subsequently, on

Veteran Communist leader R. Nallakannu passes away at 101

B. Kolappan
CHENNAI



R. Nallakannu. N. RAM

R. Nallakannu, freedom fighter and a towering figure of the Communist movement, passed away in Chennai on Wednesday. He was 101. He had been unwell and undergoing treatment at the Rajiv Gandhi Government General Hospital, where he breathed his last. He is survived by two daughters.

The body will be kept at the State headquarters of the Communist Party of India here for the public to pay homage. Following his wish, the body will be donated to Madras Medical College for medical research.

Fondly known as RNK in party circles, he chose to remain with the CPI when the Communist movement in India split in 1964 following the India-China war. He served as the Tamil Nadu State secretary of the CPI for three tenures since 1992.

A dedicated field worker and organisational man, Nallakannu led a tireless campaign against the mafia that was illegally mining sand from the Thamirabarani river basin. In 2010, he filed a PIL petition and personally argued the case in the Madras High Court, securing a stay order against sand mining.

Soft-spoken and affable, RNK embodied the values of sacrifice, idealism, and unwavering commitment to the Communist movement and social justice.

He shared with leaders such as Jeeva and K. Balahandayutham a love for the poems of poet Subramania Bharati and the hymns of the Azhvars, particularly Andal and Nammazhwar.

Police torture

RNK was sentenced to life imprisonment in the Nellai conspiracy case, along with Balahandayutham, P. Manikkam, I. Mayandibharathi, and many others. He spent many years underground during periods when the Communist Party was banned – first by the British, and later by the Congress government led by Jawaharlal Nehru. He endured severe police brutality; he was unable to grow a moustache thereafter, as a police officer had singed his upper lip with a cigarette butt.

“I was hiding in a

friend’s house when the police arrested me. After securing some bombs, they tied my hands and beat me. But I refused to reveal the names of Communist leaders,” he had said in an interview.

Born in 1925 in Srivaikundam, Thoothukudi district, RNK joined the freedom movement as a school boy, in a region that was a nerve centre of the Independence struggle, nurtured by V.O. Chidambaram.

“Political leaders would travel to Thoothukudi through my native town of Srivaikundam. I would join the local leaders in organising meetings. You should have heard Pappankulam Chockalingam speak about the Jallianwala Bagh massacre – the entire crowd would weep uncontrollably,” he recalled in a 2019 interview with *The Hindu*.

RNK was deeply troubled by the emergence of the RSS-BJP in the political landscape and always expressed concern over the undermining of public sector undertakings and trade unions. He was also in favour of unification of the Communist parties.

Vice-President’s tribute

A tribute by Vice-President C.P. Radhakrishnan, who won against RNK in the 1999 Lok Sabha election from the Coimbatore constituency as a BJP candidate, speaks volumes about the Communist leader’s character. “I was actually upset that a dignified leader like him could not win the election,” wrote Mr. Radhakrishnan in a book on RNK, *Aravazhin Adayalam*, published by *The Hindu Tamil Thisai*.

Nallakannu won the *Thagaissal Thamizhar* award of the State government in 2022. But he contributed the prize money ₹10 lakh to the Chief Minister Relief Fund along with his contribution of ₹5,000

Gandhi family, Congress are compromised, alleges BJP

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party on Wednesday accused the Gandhi family and the Congress of being “completely compromised”, claiming that they prioritised personal benefit over national interest.

At a press briefing in Patna, BJP president Nitin Nabin alleged that from the first Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru to present Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, it was the story of a “compromised legacy”. He alleged that during the Nehru rule, India’s sovereignty was compromised.

Mr. Nabin listed allegations ranging from foreign interference and corruption to “compromises” made on matters of national interest during the prime ministership of Jawaharlal Nehru, Indira Gandhi, and Rajiv Gandhi. He accused Congress leader Sonia Gandhi of running “a parallel government” during the UPA rule.

He said most of Mr. Gandhi’s 247-plus foreign trips were “not disclosed to security agencies”, and accused him of meeting “anti-India figures” abroad and visiting “sensitive border areas with George Soros-backed foreign citizens”.

‘Negative politics’

Union Minister Piyush Goyal also made similar accusations. “Mr. Gandhi has become the ‘poster boy’ of negative politics ... during foreign trips, he compromises the Yellow Book protocol [security guidelines for the protection of high-category VIPs and VVIPs] and engages in actions compromising the interests of India and its people,” Mr. Goyal alleged.

He alleged Mr. Gandhi had links with “anti-national” forces. He cited Mr. Gandhi’s meeting with U.S. Representative Ilhan Omar, who has been accused of being close to billionaire investor George Soros. “He is functioning like a puppet of foreign powers,” he said.

Rahul targets Modi over trip to Israel and trade deal with U.S., brings up ‘Epstein Files’

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Wednesday criticised Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s visit to Israel, with the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, asking “on whose orders the Prime Minister has gone to sign a deal against the country’s interest?”

In a post on X, Mr. Gandhi said he had challenged the Prime Minister to cancel the India-U.S. trade deal, but Mr. Modi had quietly left for Israel. “At least once, you’ve already ‘danced and sung’ in Israel at Epstein’s behest – so this time, on whose orders will you return after striking a deal against the country’s interests?” he said.

He was referring to emails released as part of the “Epstein Files”, in which the convicted Amer-



Rahul Gandhi

ican sex offender, the late Jeffrey Epstein, claimed that U.S. President Donald Trump played a role in the Prime Minister’s 2017 visit to Israel. However, on January 31, the Ministry of External Affairs described the contents of the emails as “trashy ruminations by a convicted criminal”.

Despite such denials, Congress leader Pawan Khera on Wednesday cited purported email exchanges between Union Minister Hardeep Puri, former Is-

raeli Prime Minister Ehud Barak and industrialist Anil Ambani, and alleged that the foundation of the India-Israel relationship was laid by Epstein. “Epstein is a notorious sex offender for the common people, but a hero for the Modi government’s foreign policy,” Mr. Khera alleged.

Earlier, Congress leader Jairam Ramesh said India had taken a moral position on Palestine and claimed that it was a different era.

“Now the Indian Prime Minister is brazenly embracing the Prime Minister of Israel, who has reduced Gaza to rubble and dust and is orchestrating the expansion of illegal settlements in the occupied West Bank. When the entire world is critical of his ‘dear friend’ Benjamin Netanyahu, Mr. Modi will be displaying moral cowardice,” he said.

Manipur MLA’s kin refuse burial till govt. announces new district and NIA probe

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

The family of Manipur BJP MLA Vungzagin Valte, who passed away at a hospital in Haryana on February 21, has refused to bury him until its demands – a separate district for the Zomi tribe and a probe by the National Investigation Agency (NIA) into his death – are met by the government, his family and community members said.

Valte belonged to the Zomi community and was assaulted by a mob on May 4, 2023 in Imphal, a day after ethnic violence erupted between the Kuki-Zo and Meitei people. He could not recover from the injuries sustained then.

Valte’s body was flown from Delhi to Aizawl in Mizoram, at the request of the family. It was brought to his residence at Churachandpur in Manipur on February 24 via road from the Lengpui airport in Aizawl. As the convoy passed, people paid tributes.

Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh is learnt to have told

the family that arrangements would be made to the accord State honours to Valte.

List with Governor

However, Valte’s son, Joseph, told *The Hindu* that the family members had handed over a list of demands to Governor Ajay Kumar Bhalla, and that the burial will not take place till they are fulfilled.

A total shutdown was observed in Churachandpur district on Tuesday. The State government had declared official mourning from February 22 to 24.

Vumsuan Naulak, chairman, Zomi Council, said a postmortem was done on Wednesday. The community leaders will convene a meeting to decide the future course of action. “We have a list of demands and till the government accepts the condition, the burial is unlikely,” Mr. Naulak said.

The three-time MLA was attacked when he was returning after attending a security review meeting. No arrests have been made in the case so far.

ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER PHED REGION-JAIPUR
Jyoti Nagar, Jaipur (Raj.) E-Mail- ac1.jpr.phed@rajasthan.gov.in
No- ACE/PHED/Ar.Dausa/ 2025-26/Date

NOTICE INVITING BID (Nit No. 03/2025-26)

On behalf of the Governor of Rajasthan NIT No. 03/2025-26 online tender is hereby invited from eligible bidders for “Water Supply Scheme for Augmentation of UWSS Lalsot, Bandikui, Mandawar and Mandawari, District Dausa including 05 years O&M after 01 year Defect Liability period under AMRUT 2.0”. Interested bidders may participated upto **06.00 PM** on dated **16.03.2026** as per criteria mentioned in the detailed NIT/Tender document available on website: <https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> & <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in>. Tenders are to be submitted online in electronic format on website <https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> as per prescribed schedule.

NIT No.	Particular	Estt. Cost (Rs. In Lakh)	UBN No.
03/2025-26	“Water Supply Scheme for Augmentation of UWSS Lalsot, Bandikui, Mandawar and Mandawari, District Dausa including 05 years O&M after 01 year Defect Liability period under AMRUT 2.0”	2640.73	PHE2526WLOB14606

NIB CODE- PHE2526A6764
Additional Chief Engineer

DIPRC/4016

GOVERNMENT OF TELANGANA
DEPARTMENT OF HORTICULTURE
INVITATION OF APPLICATIONS
ESTABLISHMENT OF OIL PALM FACTORIES IN TELANGANA
NOTIFICATION

Telangana is one of the biggest producers of Palm Oil in the Country. There is tremendous potential for Oil Palm development in Telangana. Government of Telangana has already allotted factory zones to 30 districts of the state for establishment of Oil Palm factories. Now the Government of Telangana has decided to invite applications for allotment of factory zones for Oil palm cultivation in the following Districts.

Sl.No.	District	Area identified (hectares)
1	Kumarambheem Asifabad	12221

Under Oil palm (Regulation of Production and Processing) Act 1993, Government is empowered to allot factory zones in favour of Agencies selected for Oil Palm area expansion and setting up of Oil palm processing units. Interested Firms / Companies / Co-operatives desirous of setting up of Oil Palm Processing unit may download the application form from the website <http://horticulture.tg.nic.in> on 26.02.2026. The filled application form to be submitted in the Oil palm Section, O/o, Director of Horticulture, Public Gardens, Hyderabad - 500004 on or before 10.03.2026, 5.00 PM by paying an amount of Rs.20,000/- (Non-refundable) towards application fee and Security deposit of Rs.1,00,000/- through separate DDs in favour of Secretary, SHN, Payable at Hyderabad. Applications may also be obtained from Oil palm Section, O/o, Director of Horticulture, Public Gardens, Hyderabad - 500004 on all working days from 17.03.2026 onwards, between 10.30 AM to 5.00 PM, by paying an amount of Rs.20,000/- (Non-refundable) through DD in favour of Secretary, SHN, Payable at Hyderabad. Last date for submission of completely filled in applications is 10.03.2026, 5.00 PM.

Sd/- Director of Horticulture, Telangana State

DIPR R.O.No.1217-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/11/2025 Dt:25-02-2026

Odisha Police - Office of the D.G & I.G. of Police, Odisha, Cuttack
Tel. : 9671-2304001, Website : www.odishapolice.gov.in, Email: aig-prov.odpol@od.gov.in

RFP No. 41-RFP-Water Cannon -2025-2026 Date : 24.02.2026

Online Bids through e-Tender Portal <https://tenders.odisha.gov.in> are invited from the eligible bidders for Supply of Water Cannon for Odisha Police, Odisha, Cuttack, during the current financial year 2025-26 as per the schedule mentioned below.

Sl.No.	Name of Item	Approximate quantity
1.	41-RFP-Water Cannon - 2025-2026	02 Nos

Events	Date
RFP Issue Date	24.02.2026
RFP Submission Due Date and time	05.03.2026 at 11.00 AM
Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bids	05.03.2026 at 03.00 PM
Bid to RA enabled	Yes
Tender Document fee ((Non-refundable Rs.590/-+ 18% GST (Rs. 90/-))	In favour of A.I.G. of Police (Prov), Odisha, Cuttack payable at Cuttack, (Demand Draft)
EMD (Earnest Money Deposit) Rs: 2,48,000/- (Two Lakh forty-eight thousand only)	In favour of A.I.G. of Police (Prov), Odisha, Cuttack payable at Cuttack, (Demand Draft)

The bid document with all information relating to the bidding process including cost of bid document, Prequalification criteria and terms & conditions are available in the websites: <https://tenders.odisha.gov.in>. The Authority reserves the right to accept / reject any part thereof or all the bids without assigning any reason therefor.

A.I.G. of Police (Provisioning), Odisha, Cuttack, (Tender Calling Authority)

12001/34/2526 OIPR-12001/12018/1/25-26/0004

Bhubaneswar Development Authority
Akash Shova Building, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar -751001, Odisha. Ph: 0674-2396437

Notice No: 3701/ BDA
BDA-PPP-PLAN-0001-2026 (OSWAS)

Date : 18/02/2026

Request for Proposal (RFP)
COMPOSITE COMMUNITY MARKET & HIGH-END RESIDENTIAL/COMMERCIAL FACILITIES over Prime land at Jharpada, Bhubaneswar on Public Private Partnership (PPP) - Call 2

The Bhubaneswar Development Authority (BDA) invites Private Developers for the development of a Composite Project including a Community Market and Residential and/or Commercial facilities over 0.7818 Ha (1 932 Ac) of prime freehold land at Bhubaneswar on PPP mode. The site enjoys a frontage on both the 24 meters wide Jail Road and 9 meters wide Jharpada road. Additionally, the proposed 60 meters wide Jharpada Canal Road (CDP Road) will add greater proximity to the site.

Interested agencies may participate in this tender through the e-procurement portal of the Government of Odisha. The RFP documents will be available from 20.02.2026 to 23.03.2026 and can be downloaded from www.odishatenders.gov.in. The completed proposal, as per instruction in the RFP document, should be uploaded in the portal latest by 23.03.2026 up to 1600 hrs. The Pre-Bid meeting is on 06.03.2026 at 1600 hrs. at the Office of the BDA. Please refer to the RFP document for further details.

BDA reserves the right to cancel this invitation and / or invite fresh Bid / RFP with or without amendments to this invitation, without liability or any obligation for such invitation and without assigning any reason. BDA reserves the right to accept or reject any or all proposals without assigning any reason whatsoever.

Sd/- Secretary-cum-Member Estate, Bhubaneswar Development Authority

13001/369/2526 OIPR-13001/13033/1/25-26/0037

INBRIEF



Yes Bank reports ₹2.55 crore unauthorised transactions

Yes Bank on Wednesday said fraudsters had conducted unauthorised transactions worth \$0.28 million (₹2.55 crore) using Multi-Currency Prepaid Forex Cards of 5,000 customers. These cards were issued in partnership with BookMyForex.com. Yes Bank said the transactions came to light after the private sector lender’s fraud monitoring system declined an unusual increase in transactions conducted overnight at a Latin American country.

Facebook Overseas buys 30% stake in RIL firm for ₹257 cr.

Reliance Industries Ltd. (RIL) said Reliance Enterprise Intelligence Ltd (REIL), its step-down wholly owned subsidiary, allotted 85,31,75,000 equity shares of face value of ₹10 each, at par to Reliance Intelligence Ltd. (Reliance Intelligence), its wholly owned subsidiary and Facebook Overseas, Inc. (Facebook), a wholly owned unit of Meta Platforms, Inc. It said 25,65,52,500 equity shares aggregating ₹256.6 crore were allotted to Facebook Overseas Inc.

‘Govt. mandates sale of E20 petrol with minimum RON 95’

The Centre has mandated the sale of petrol with up to 20% ethanol and a minimum Research Octane Number (RON) of 9 from April 1. The Oil Ministry, in a February 17 notification, said, “the Central government hereby directs oil companies to sell ethanol-blended motor spirit (petrol) with percentage of ethanol up to 20% as per Bureau of Indian Standards specifications and having minimum Research Octane Number (RON) of 95, in States and the Union Territories”. PTI

‘SECL, Chhattisgarh eyeing floating solar, coal gasification JVs’

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

South Eastern Coalfields Ltd. (SECL) is exploring joint-ventures with the State government of Chhattisgarh for floating solar and surface coal gasification projects, CMD Harish Duhan told *The Hindu*.

The miner aspires to institute 626 megawatt (MW) of solar energy capacity by FY2027-28. Further, the joint venture on gasifica-



Harish Duhan

tion is part of the design to pursue the method in a revenue-sharing mode. Elaborating on the ongoing discussions about

floating solar, Mr. Duhan stated, “We have had discussions with the Chhattisgarh State Power Generation Company Ltd. to pursue floating solar projects considering the State is blessed with large reservoirs,” adding, “At present, a guiding larger policy on the front is to be formulated [within the State], and discussions are ongoing.” Mr. Duhan stated SECL would also be looking to tap into closed mines to es-

tablish solar power projects alongside contributing to parent Coal India’s ongoing projects in Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh.

Gasification push
Mr. Duhan held discussions about a coal gasification JV with Chhattisgarh government and it is at the “conceptual stages”. “At present, the Chhattisgarh government is looking to incentivise coal gasi-



Get going: Staffers have to get their hands dirty and build solutions using AI tools, says K. Krithivasan. REUTERS

‘TCS ok with revenue cannibalisation via AI’

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) is “not afraid” of artificial intelligence, and is not worried about potential “cannibalisation” that AI deployment would entail, said K. Kirthivasan, MD and CEO of the country’s largest IT company. The top boss of TCS said senior level staff are slower in building AI-based solutions compared with the “proficient” younger staff. “We encourage our associates to go out (to customers and use AI)... even if it means cannibalising our revenue,” he said.

TCS was “insisting” that each of its more than six lakh staffers update themselves with AI, Mr. Krithivasan said, adding it had no fears of the company taking away livelihood. **AI motivation** Mr. Krithivasan said there was motivation to learn new AI skills but as they approached higher designations, they tend to read a lot but not do anything. It is not about just giving a few prompts to a generational AI platform such as ChatGPT, he said, adding staffers have to get their hands dirty and build solutions using the AI tools.

Carbon credits for Maruti railway siding

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Maruti Suzuki India Ltd (Maruti Suzuki) said its Gujarat in-plant railway siding has been registered as the world’s first modal shift transportation project under the Verified Carbon Standard (VCS) programme of Verra, a global carbon credit registry.

The project is expected to achieve approximately 1.7 lakh carbon credits over a 10-year crediting period from FY24 to FY33, by shifting vehicle dispatches from road to rail, the company said in a statement.

Emission reduction The emission reduction has been quantified under the AM0090 methodology prescribed under Clean Development Mechanism (CDM) of the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC). Following independent verification of carbon emission saving, Verra will issue 1.7 lakh carbon credits to Maruti Suzuki under its VCS program, it added. Hisashi Takeuchi, ma-



The railway siding eased road congestion, cut fossil-fuel use.

naging director & CEO, Maruti Suzuki India Ltd. said in a statement, “By transitioning vehicle movement from road to rail, the project demonstrates how scale, operational efficiency and environmental responsibility can seamlessly go hand in hand.” **‘Cut carbon footprint’** “Leveraging the inherent efficiency of rail transport, the Gujarat in-plant railway siding has significantly reduced the carbon footprint of our logistics operations, while also easing road congestion and lowering overall fossil fuel consumption,” he said.

Business

U.S. slaps 126% levy on Indian solar imports

Tariffs were slapped on India, Indonesia and Laos following an ongoing probe; In FY23, India exported \$1 billion worth photovoltaics to the U.S.

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

The Trump administration slapped 126% levy on solar cell imports from India following a ‘preliminary’ determination that subsidised exports from Indian firms were hurting the competitiveness of U.S. solar firms and contravened World Trade Organization agreements on subsidies.

The tariffs were collectively imposed on February 24 on India, Indonesia and Laos following a probe by the U.S. Department of Commerce on a complaint by the Alliance for American Solar Manufacturing and Trade, a coalition of leading U.S. solar firms. Indian firms under the U.S. Commerce Ministry’s radar included Mundra Solar Energy Pvt. Ltd. and Mundra Solar PV Ltd. — both part of Adani Group — Premier Energies Photovoltaic Private Ltd., Waaree Energies Ltd. and Waaree Solar Americas. The department set initial rates of 86%-143% for Indonesia and 81% for Laos.

Framework deal This levy comes after New Delhi and Washington agreed on a framework for the India-U.S. trade deal to cut tariffs on India’s exports to 18% from 50% earlier. After this, the U.S. Supreme Court quashed Trump tariffs, calling them unconstitutional. Presi-



Dark days: Staff inspecting solar panels on assembly lines at an Adani Group factory in Gujarat’s port city of Mundra. AFP FILE

dent Trump then came up with a new 15% baseline duty on several imports. On February 24, per a notice on the U.S. Commerce Ministry site, it was Adani firms that were specifically named with a duty rates of 125.87% though these rates, as of now, apply to all Indian exporters.

May be impacted *The Hindu* didn’t receive comments from the firms as of press time. However, given the U.S. is the biggest export destination for solar parts, Indian exports could likely be ‘impacted.’ The implications of the order were still being studied, a spokesperson for Solex Energy Ltd., a Surat-based solar firm told *The Hindu*. “There will be an impact as the U.S. is a major export destination. How much... still needs to be determined. Some months sees a surge in exports and less in others, so

it could well be, we won’t see an impact beyond the immediate quarter,” the person explained. Currently duties of up to 40% are imposed on such export of solar cells. These duties are additional to existing tariffs. The final determination in the CVD investigations are now scheduled to be issued on July 6, 2026. The U.S. Commerce Department is conducting concurrent anti-dumping duty probe of solar cells from India, Indonesia and Laos. According to data cited by U.S. authorities, Indian firms in 2022 exported 232 mega watts (MW) worth of solar cells which rose to 2049 MW in 2023 and 2297 MW in 2024. In 2022-23 \$1,000 million worth photovoltaics were exported and that rose to \$1,939.92 million in 2023-24. Exports stood at \$954 million in April-December 2025.

PMO meets on CAFE-3 norms

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

The Prime Minister’s Office (PMO) held a meeting on Wednesday to review the proposed carbon emission norms for passenger vehicles slated to take effect from 2027, though no final decision was reached.

A senior government official who was part of the high-level meeting said that there was “no final decision yet”, on the contentious issue of draft Corporate Average Fuel Efficiency (CAFE)-3 norms which have divided small and big carmakers. Officials of the Ministry of Power, Bureau of Energy Efficiency, and Ministry of Heavy Industries were part of the meeting. Speaking to reporters on the sidelines of a FICCI event, Minister for Heavy Industries H.D. Kumaraswamy said about the proposal, “We already had a meeting with stakeholders and Power Ministry. The Power Ministry, according to my information, sent the proposal to the PMO.”

On contents of the proposal, he said, “whatever best way we have to encourage for electric mobility, we are going to take.”

Revised draft The Bureau of Energy Efficiency recently circulated a revised draft of the CAFE III norms to the industry after the earlier version released in September last year triggered divisions among automakers with larger vehicle manufacturers opposing certain relaxations extended to small-



No final decision was taken on CAFE-3 norms.

car makers. The latest proposal, shared with car manufacturers but not yet made public, has removed the 3 g CO2/km waiver for cars weighing up to 909 kg and with engine capacity not exceeding 1200 cc. It has also made the emission slope flatter. Against the initial 0.002 value for all five years, the new proposal is 0.00153 in year one, followed by an annual reduction so as to reach 0.00128 in the fifth year. This means permissible emissions for heavier vehicles are lower than before, while small cars get some relief.

Addressing the third FICCI National Conference on Electric Vehicles, Mr. Kumaraswamy said, “electric mobility today is not merely a climate initiative, it is an industrial strategy, a manufacturing opportunity, supply-chain recalibration and a technological leap.” Citing the progress of the ₹10,900 crore PM E-DRIVE scheme, he said as of February, over 28 lakh EVs have been sold under the scheme.

MARKETS

MARKET WATCH

	WEDNESDAY	% CHANGE
Sensex	82,276	0.06
US Dollar	96.91	0.04
Brent oil	70.60	-0.73

NIFTY 50

	PRICE	CHANGE
Adani Enter.....	2231.70	-48.70
Adani Ports.....	1528.70	-26.70
Apollo Hosp.....	7783.00	-62.50
Asian Paints.....	2416.40	-3.30
Axis Bank.....	1403.00	-15.40
Bajaj Auto.....	10097.00	268.00
Bajaj Finserv.....	2048.30	-6.00
Bajaj Finance.....	1021.05	-2.50
Bharat Elec.....	439.30	-4.25
Bharti Airtel.....	1913.40	-27.60
Cipla.....	1346.10	-19.40
Coal India.....	438.60	-7.65
Dr Reddys Lab.....	1306.50	-6.30
Eicher Motors.....	8008.00	-79.00
Eternal Ltd.....	250.20	-3.80
Grasim Ind.....	2878.40	-0.90
HCL Tech.....	1378.20	-39.00
HDFC Bank.....	907.60	-2.90
HDFC Life.....	735.25	-0.50
Hindalco.....	937.40	-14.55
Hind Unilever.....	2374.90	-16.30
ICI Bank.....	1400.50	-15.70
IntGlobeAvl.....	4947.40	-97.10
Infosys.....	1259.10	-14.60
ITC.....	319.75	-3.75
Jio Financial Service.....	256.95	-1.70
JSW Steel.....	1275.00	-20.50
Kotak Bank.....	424.95	-2.75
L&T.....	4298.50	-39.30
M&M.....	3491.30	-58.10
Maruti Suzuki.....	15070.00	144.00
Max Healthcare.....	1088.10	-1.70
NestleIndia.....	1323.40	-3.40
NTPC.....	384.90	-2.15
ONGC.....	277.45	-0.95
PowerGrid Corp.....	307.25	-2.45
Reliance Ind.....	1398.50	-30.30
SBI Life.....	2073.60	-9.30
State Bank.....	1200.10	-23.20
Shriram Finance.....	1085.90	-24.20
Sun Pharma.....	1764.20	-32.40
TataConsumerProduct.....	1172.30	-5.70
Tata Steel.....	214.64	-5.51
TCS.....	2629.30	-55.60
Tech Mahindra.....	1361.80	-16.40
Titan.....	4325.00	-30.50
Trent Motors PV.....	381.85	-4.30
Trent Ltd.....	3922.00	-9.30
UltraTech Cement.....	13041.00	-81.00
Wipro.....	201.92	-1.78

Zendesk sets up innovation hub

Zendesk said it set up an Innovation Hub for Research and Development in Pune thus growing its footprint in India. The hub team of almost 300 is set to grow by 15% before the end of 2026, the company said.

‘DRL semaglutide may make March debut’

Reuters
MUMBAI

Indian drugmaker Dr. Reddy’s Laboratories (DRL) is likely to launch its generic semaglutide injection in the country in March under the brand name Obeda, according to two people familiar with the matter. Patent protection for semaglutide expires in India

in March 2026, triggering a rush among Indian drugmakers to prepare lower-cost versions. Dr. Reddy’s plans to sell about 12 million injectable semaglutide pens in the first year and intends to price it competitively, potentially up to 60% below the branded product, co-Chairman and MD G.V. Prasad told *Reuters* last week.

डॉ. सर्वपल्ली राधाकृष्णन्
राजस्थान आयुर्वेद विश्वविद्यालय, जोधपुर
प्रशासनिक कार्यालय, जोधपुर, राजस्थान (फ़ोन नं. 342037)
Web side : www.rajujodhpur.org , E-mail- dsrrauao@gmail.com
क्रमांक :- रा.आ.वि./जोधा/सेवा/निविदा/2025-26/755 दिनांक :- 19/02/2026

Notice Inviting Bid

Tenders are invited from interested bidders for Dr. S.R. Rajasthan Ayurved University, Karwad, Jodhpur. Whose details are as follows:-

1. **UBN No. AUJ2526WSOB00062** Tender for E-Procurement for Stengthing, Renewal of Internal Road Work at DSRRAU Campus

2. **UBN No. AUJ2526SLOB00064** Tender for E-Procurement of Request for Proposal of Interested Agencies for Computer based Recruitment Test

All particulars of the bid may be visited on the portal <https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in/> and <https://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in/>

का.सं.वेदर/सी/25/21073 कुलसचिव

OFFICE OF THE PRINCIPAL S.M.S. MEDICAL COLLEGE & CONTROLLER OF THE ATTACHED HOSPITALS, JAIPUR
No-FI/MC/Store /2025-26/14230-34 Dated: 11/02/2026

Notice Inviting Bid

Bid for procurement of below mentioned items at SMS Medical College, Jaipur, are invited from interested bidders as per schedule in NIT Notice. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the Procurement portal (<http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in>)/(<https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in>) of the state; and SMS Medical College, Jaipur department website.

UBN SMS2526GLOB00665

DIPRC/3328 PRINCIPAL & CONTROLLER

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GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
DEPARTMENT OF SPACE
CMG, SDSC - SHAR SRIHARIKOTA - 524124

Brief E- TENDER NOTICE: CORRIGENDUM-A [SALE EXTENSION]

No: SHAR:CMG CIVIL: MAINT: E-PublicTender-16(A)/25-26 Dt: 24.02.2026

Kindly refer to E-Public Tender-16/25-26 dated 29.01.2026 “AMC for Civil, PH, Water supply etc at PNN & SMN colonies for the year 2026-27” (T/C-25-059, Est. cost ₹188.38 Lakhs);

Sale period extended upto to 09.03.2026

Interested tenderers may visit www.isro.gov.in or www.tenderwizard.com/ISRO for details.

Sd/- GROUP HEAD, CMG/SDSC SHAR

International Institute of Information Technology Bangalore (IIIT-B)

TENDER NOTICE

International Institute of Information Technology Bangalore invites Expressions of Interest (EOI) from eligible and experienced **Construction Firms** for Construction of Additional Campus Facilities.

EOI Ref: **IIITB/EOI/2026/01**

Date: **20-Feb-2026**

EOI document available at: www.iiitb.ac.in/tenders

Last date for submission: **07-Mar-2026, 5:00 PM**

Contact: cao@iiitb.ac.in | 080-2852-7627

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, PUBLIC HEALTH DIVISION, BALANGIR.
E-mail ID: eephbgr@yahoo.co.in ; Ph.No.-(06652 - 234647)

NOTICE INVITING TENDERS - NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING THROUGH e-Procurement

Bid Identification No. ACEPHBGR 19/2025-26 Dt. 18.02.2026

01. Name of the Work : 06 No.

02. Estimated Cost : Approx.,Rs,11.28 Lakhs to 688,91 Lakhs

03. Period of Completion : 1 Month to 12 Months

04. Date & Time of availability of bid document in the portal : From 11.00 AM of dt.26.02.2026 to 5.00 PM of dt.12.03.2026

05. Last date / time of receipt of bids in the portal : 5 PM of dt. 12.03.2026

06. Date & Time of opening of bids : At 11.00 AM of dt.13.03.2026

07. Name and Address of the Officer Inviting Bid. : The Superintending Engineer, Office Of The Superintending Engineer, Public Health Division, Balangir, At-Tulasinagar, Po/Dist-Balangir,Pin-767001, Odisha, Phone:-06652-234647; E-mail:-eephbgr@yahoo.co.in

Further details can be seen from the web site “<https://tenders.ori.nic.in> or www.tendersodisha.gov.in”

Addl. Chief Engineer, P.H.Division, Balangir.

130011376/2526 OIPR-1300113005/1/25-26/002

Raza will 100% play against India, confirms Zimbabwe's Burl



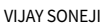
Kuldeep's inclusion at the expense of an all-rounder is difficult: Kotak



'I have to give a lot more credit to Muzarabani than he has received'



Reifer believes WI has inspired its next generation of cricketers



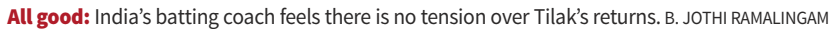
An off-colour Men in Blue in a battle for survival

New Zealand sends Lanka packing

South Africa, West Indies hope to inch closer to the semifinals

The victory over India boosted our confidence: Maharaj

"I think it speaks to the character within the lineup, and that's a huge thing for us. In previous World Cups, we never crossed over those small moments. If the character is strong in such situations, it propels us to go further on in this tournament," said Maharaj.



Including Samson in the mix has been discussed: Kotak

"Rinku's father wasn't well, so he went back. I think he is coming back this evening [Wednesday]".

Pressure does funny things to teams: Burl

Asked about Indian batters' recent struggles against finger spinners, Burl said: "It's something that we have taken into account. We've done our homework, and it's something that we would be silly to ignore going into the game."

Chepauk and its colourful legacy of delivering classics

The Indian team would hope to have another memorable outing at the M.A. Chidambaram Stadium when it squares off against Zimbabwe in the T20 World Cup Super Eight encounter; a win will bring the Suryakumar-led side back on track in the global tournament

R. Kaushik
CHENNAI

There is an aura about the M.A. Chidambaram Stadium that's hard to express in words. Terms associated with Chepauk that one first heard on the radio - the V. Pattabhiraman Gate, the Wallajah Road End - surge to your mind as you negotiate the broad gates and cast your eyes on the lush-green, newly laid outfield which cuts a pretty picture. The refurbished Madras Cricket Club serves as a reminder of the traditional sprucing itself up to keep in tune with the modern. The steeping new stand crammed with blue seats is another example of the necessity of having to embrace the new reality even if it is somewhat at the expense of spectator comfort. Rows of seats almost tumble over each other and negotiating the narrow passage to reach one's perch towards the end of a row is a huge challenge.

The famous tied Test
Think Chepauk, and the first thought is of the tied Test of September 1986. Nearly 40 years ago, to have to score 348 in a single day's play, and that too on the final day of a Test, was almost unheard of. That's the target Allan Border set Kapil Dev's men on September 22. India made a game fist of it with Sunil Gavaskar, who has lit up the venue with several incandescent efforts, leading the way. The little master top-scored with 90 as each of the top five made at least 39, and at 251 for three, an improbable victory appeared imminent. Ray Bright, the left-arm spinner, then got into the act alongside Greg Matthews, the maverick off-spinner who preferred bowling with his Baggy Green on. Ravi Shastri held firm and Chetan Sharma weighed in with 23 but when Shivlal Yadav was ninth man dismissed, India needed four for victory with Maninder Singh joining Shastri. The latter was a master at playing the situation. Instead of going for the glory shot that might have brought about his downfall, he first ensured that India would not lose the game, leaving Maninder on strike to Matthews with the scores level. As the off-spinner pinged the No. 11 on his pad, umpire Vikram Raju's right index finger shot skywards, upholding the appeal and sending one side into paroxysms of delight. The other's immediate reaction was disappointment; to this day, Shastri and Maninder insist there was an inside-edge, Raju is adamant there was no contact between bat and ball. It doesn't matter anymore, does it? With that one act which brought an end to India's chase and a riveting Test match, Raju had formalised only the second 'tie' in the history of Test cricket. Australia had been involved in both games where the match had ended with the teams dead level in terms of runs scored when the dust had settled and the final wicket had fallen.

Chennai's knowledgeable crowd
India have endured numerous heartbreaks here, including a one-run loss to Australia the following year in the 50-over World Cup, and a 12-run defeat to Wasim Akram's men in Pakistan's first Test in India in nearly a dozen years. Over the years, the Chennai crowd has earned the reputation of being one of India's most knowledgeable and sporting groups. It lived up to that billing by applauding Pakistan, a gesture the visitors reciprocated by going on a victory lap around the ground that was received with a standing ovation. Among India's fonder memories is a magnificent two-wicket win over Australia in March 2001, fashioned by the right arm of Harbhajan Singh and the magical wrists

of V.V.S. Laxman which combined to orchestrate one of the greatest comebacks in the five-day game. Out for the count after a three-day wallop in Mumbai, India squared the series in a classic at the Eden Gardens - a Harbhajan hat-trick was matched and topped by Laxman's 281 and Rahul Dravid's 180 as they batted out the entire fourth day after the host trailed by 276 in the first innings. India then completed a fightback for the ages at Chepauk, nailing a modest but tense chase as the shadows lengthened and hearts thudded furiously in one of the great advertisements for the format.

Platform for 50-over WC rampage
It's here that India kicked off their fabulous run in the 2023 50-over World Cup with a splendid six-wicket victory over Australia. Asked to scale down a modest 199, India were rocked by Mitchell Starc and Josh Hazlewood, who fired out skipper Rohit Sharma, Ishan Kishan and Shreyas Iyer, all for ducks, with just two runs on the board. There is no gainsaying how the match would have panned out had Mitchell Marsh, at



square-leg, not put down Virat Kohli when the batter was on 12. Had the catch been completed, India would have been 20 for four. Kohli made Australia pay by putting on 165 for the fourth wicket with K.L. Rahul as India eventually cantered home with 52 deliveries to spare. That escape to victory was the start of a spectacular charge through the draw that took the Indians to the final with an all-win record. The title proved elusive with Travis Head lording the Ahmedabad exchanges and casting a collective pall of gloom over the entire nation, which quickly regrouped to applaud Rohit's team for the exhilarating brand of cricket they had showcased throughout the month and a half of the tournament. Now, India must again use Chepauk to resuscitate their campaign at the T20 World Cup. Justified favouritism conferred on them coming into the tournament for their consistently commanding run in the 20-over game over the last year and a half, India were untroubled in the league phase despite barely touching third gear. But now, they are within three and a half hours of going out before the knockouts.

Do-or-die game for Surya's side
The defending champions were dealt a hammer blow by last edition's finalists South Africa in Ahmedabad on Sunday. Now, another African challenger looms in the form of Zimbabwe, a dark horse if ever there was one, which has punched above its weight and taken down Australia and Sri Lanka in the first stage. What makes Zimbabwe's fairytale run even more endearing and remarkable is that they failed to even qualify for the 2024 edition of this tournament in the Americas. They weren't expected, understandably but as it turns out now, naively, to advance to Super Eights but they proved that their takedown of Australia was no flash in the pan with a convincing victory over the co-hosts in Colombo to top Group B. Sikandar Raza has run a tight ship and led by example, while the engine rooms of their charge have been Blessing Muzarabani at the top of the bowling tree and the intrepid Brian Bennett at the top of the batting group. After unbeaten efforts in his three previous outings of 48, 64 and 63 respectively, the 22-year-old Bennett finally had an average (180) to boast when he was dismissed for five against the West Indies in their opening Super Eight encounter in Mumbai on Monday. Muzarabani, the towering 29-year-old quick, has 11 wickets, the joint second-highest in the tournament alongside Marco Jansen, and has gone for only 7.06 runs per over. **Men who could spoil the day** Bennett and Muzarabani are the most obvious threats but the captain is a wonderfully skilled competitor who will undoubtedly fancy his off-spin to wreak damage in the first over of the Indian innings - the hosts have lost a wicket within the first six deliveries four times in

their five encounters thus far. He can also give the ball a mighty whack, all of which means that India's task is anything but straightforward. Suryakumar Yadav's men have had just one bad day in the office, but it was a horribly bad one, which has left them now dependent on other results going their way if they aspire to be in the hunt for the semifinals. Of course, the primary requirement for them, after the 76-run lashing at the Narendra Modi Stadium, is to win their two remaining games - the West Indies lie in store at the Eden on Sunday. Before the tournament, it was unthinkable that India wouldn't figure in the last four but that's now very much a possibility. The Super Eights is an unforgiving phase though unlike the knockouts, there is at least a nominal second chance.

India's batting has been the source of much debate and no little censure in the last few days. Much of it has to do with the unrealistic expectations from the outside, expectations that are not in sync with reality. Apart from the opening game against the United States where they found themselves in all kinds of trouble at 77 for six before scrambling to 161, they reached above-par scores, given the nature of the pitches, against Namibia (209), Pakistan (175) and the Netherlands (193). Ahmedabad was a horror night. First, through defensive fields and bowling changes, India allowed South Africa to escape from 20 for three to 187 for seven. Then, the chase unravelled even before it started with Kishan and Tilak Varma perishing in the first seven balls and the luckless Abhishek Sharma also falling in the PowerPlay.

Hanging by a thread
Abhishek's travails are too obvious and well documented to bear repetition. Three ducks and a scratchy 15 have pushed him to the brink of losing his place in the XI, with Sanju Samson primed to open alongside Kishan. Abhishek might thus be deprived the chance of working his way back among the runs on what has consistently been the best scoring venue at the World Cup. But he will also understand that there is no place for sentiment and hand-holding anymore, not with India's campaign hanging by a slender, tenuous thread. Even had they put it past South Africa, there would have been no scope for complacency or smugness against the Zimbabweans. Now, the Indians have even more reason to be fully switched on. Some two and a half weeks ago, Suryakumar had the opportunity to reprise the magic of Mahendra Singh Dhoni and Rohit and become only the third Indian captain to lift the T20 World Cup. Now, he is in danger of emulating Kohli from 2021 by helming a side that failed to reach the knockouts for the first time in three editions. That's how quickly things change in the 20-over game.

THE GIST

- Think Chepauk, and the first thought is of the tied Test of September 1986
- Among India's fonder memories is a magnificent two-wicket win over Australia in March 2001
- It's at this venue India kicked off their fabulous run in the 2023 50-over World Cup with a splendid victory over Australia. Now, India must again use Chepauk to resuscitate their campaign at the T20 World Cup

FILE PHOTO: R. RAGU

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Number of tourists rescued after heavy snowfall in East Sikkim

2,736 Over 2,700 tourists stranded due to heavy snowfall near the Tsomgo Lake in East Sikkim were rescued. Heavy snowfall in the higher reaches of Sherathang and adjoining areas led to road blockages, leaving 541 tourist vehicles stranded. PTI

People released since amnesty law took effect in Venezuela

3,200 A special commission of Venezuela's National Assembly announced that over 3,200 people have been released since the amnesty law took effect four days ago. This group includes both former detainees and those previously under house arrest. PTI

HIV patients undergoing treatment in Meghalaya

10,293 Meghalaya has the highest HIV caseload in India with over 10,000 patients receiving antiretroviral therapy, Health Minister W. Shylla said. She stated that the State has already approved a ₹25 crore mission-mode programme. PTI

Displaced persons in South Sudan at risk due to funding gaps

1.9 million. The lives of more than 1.9 million displaced people in South Sudan are being put at risk due to aid funding shortages, the UN's migration agency said. South Sudan, the world's newest sovereign country, has been beset by civil war, poverty and massive corruption. AFP

Share of the pollution control budget which has been utilised

43 per cent. Around 43% of ₹300 crore allocated under pollution control and emergency measures in the Delhi budget for 2025-26 has been utilised till January 20. The environment department of Delhi stated that ₹129.83 crore was spent. PTI

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How are Indian firms training LLMs?

Why is training a Large Language Model on Indian soil with Indian capital a challenge? How has the IndiaAI Mission subsidised efforts to conduct training in India? Why is a Mixture of Experts (MoE) architecture inexpensive than other comparable models?

EXPLAINER

Aroon Deep

The story so far:

At the AI Impact Summit, the Bengaluru-based startup Sarvam AI released two Large Language Models (LLMs), which are the foundation for AI systems that power services like Google's Gemini and OpenAI's ChatGPT. The two models were trained on 35 billion and 105 billion parameters respectively, and were less power- and compute-intensive than comparable models, while demonstrating improvements over other models in Indian languages, Pratyush Kumar, a Sarvam co-founder said.

How are LLMs trained?

LLMs are trained and operated on clusters of Graphics Processing Units (GPUs). The combined cost of the GPUs and the electricity needed to run them long enough to train a model, run into millions of dollars. The grist for this mill is data, largely scraped from the Internet, where English, European languages and East Asian languages like Korean and Japanese are more richly represented than Indian languages.

This creates a twofold challenge for training an LLM on Indian soil with Indian capital: for one thing, with scarce data sources, many LLMs either perform worse when operating on Indian languages, or burn more "tokens" on inference to translate sentences into English (and translating responses back) to perform better. Since machine translation has improved dramatically for Indian languages, this remains the gold standard for many LLMs. Secondly, since capital is also scarce, efforts to train an LLM by Indian firms targeting Indian users can be challenging, especially if there is no immediate business use case for doing so.

Using translations as a fulcrum can be a



New innovations: Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Sarvam co-founder Pratyush Kumar at the AI Impact Summit, at Bharat Mandapam, in New Delhi on February 19. PTI

challenge for developers who want to leverage local LLMs – like Sarvam's 35 billion parameter model, which was shown off in a demo during the summit's research symposium working on a feature phone – where suboptimal performance in Indian languages can impact adoption and quality of performance.

Has there been government support?

The IndiaAI Mission has subsidised efforts to conduct training in India, by commissioning over 36,000 GPUs in data centres operated by Indian firms like Yotta, and allowing researchers and startups to run training and inference workloads at a relatively nominal fee. The government gave Sarvam access to 4,096 GPUs from its common compute cluster, and the subsidy so far is estimated at

almost ₹100 crore. The "bill of materials" for this cluster is ₹246 crore, though these GPUs can probably be continued to be used by others.

The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology has encouraged domestic LLM development for many reasons. The main one is a belief that foreign-developed LLMs can't possibly find the capabilities or the business case to develop the capacity to work well with Indian languages. Additionally, encouraging talent that can train LLMs has been seen as important to foster the Indian AI ecosystem.

As such, Sarvam's announcement of its two models is a significant development in India's own quest to develop a powerful and relatively inexpensive LLM. When China's DeepSeek developed its R1

LLM, the entire AI industry quickly adopted its techniques, as it saved on cost for training and inference without compromising output quality. The government has sought to spark a similar cost advantage.

Mr. Kumar of Sarvam said that the LLM was trained "from scratch," and that the model would be made open source. However, while it has been made available on an app named Indus, it is not available on platforms like Hugging Face, making it difficult for outside experts to scrutinise the claims the firm has made.

What is the MoE architecture?

A key breakthrough for AI models seeking to function locally was the Mixture of Experts (MoE) architecture. When the first LLMs trained on hundreds of billions or even over a trillion parameters were launched, inference was typically run by "activating" all parameters, making queries expensive. But an MoE model only activates a fraction of the overall parameters of a model, making it run faster and also consume a lower level of computing resources.

Even 105 billion parameters, Sarvam acknowledges, "is significantly smaller than the frontier models powering global consumer chat applications today," and the firm says it is "intentionally focused on accuracy, usefulness, efficiency, and alignment for the Indian context before training bigger foundational models".

As such, the answers are not as in-depth as a response from paid versions of Gemini or ChatGPT. That part will come later, Sarvam says, when it has the necessary investments to put money into a larger training run.

Another LLM developed and trained on the common compute cluster was by BharatGen, the IIT Bombay-incubated firm that was able to train a "multilingual" 17 billion parameter model. That model, the firm says, is for use in sectors like education and healthcare. Gnani.ai, another firm, launched a small text-to-speech model.

THE GIST

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What are carbon capture and utilisation technologies?

How can such technologies reduce carbon dioxide emissions? What is the EU Bioeconomy Strategy and Circular Economy Action Plan? How can India scale-up CCU technology?

Shambhavi Naik

The story so far:

Carbon Capture and Utilisation (CCU) refers to a set of technologies that capture carbon dioxide emissions from industrial sources or directly from the air and convert them into useful products. This process removes carbon from the atmosphere and puts it into the economy as inputs for fuels, chemicals, building materials, or polymers. Unlike carbon capture and storage, where captured CO₂ is permanently stored underground rather than reused, CCU uses up the captured carbon.

Why does India need CCU?

India has consistently been the world's third-largest emitter of CO₂, with emissions driven largely by power generation, cement, steel, and chemicals.

While renewable energy may reduce future emissions, many industrial processes are inherently carbon-intensive and difficult to decarbonise. CCU offers a pathway to reduce emissions from these "hard-to-abate" sectors while simultaneously creating new industrial value chains. It also aligns with India's net-zero target for 2070 and its push to build a circular, low-carbon economy.

Where does India stand today?

India has begun supporting CCU through research funding from the Department of Science and Technology which has created a specific research and development roadmap for these technologies. The draft 2030 roadmap for Carbon Utilisation and Storage (CCUS) presented by the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural gas has identified projects that can be used for CCUS purposes. In the private sector, Ambuja Cements

(Adani Group) is working on an Indo-Swedish CCU pilot with IIT Bombay to convert captured CO₂ into fuels and materials. JK Cement is collaborating on a CCU testbed to capture CO₂ for applications such as lightweight concrete blocks and olefins. Beyond cement, Organic Recycling Systems Limited (ORSL) is leading India's first pilot-scale Bio-CCU platform, valorising CO₂ from biogas streams into bio-alcohols and specialty chemicals.

What are other countries doing?

The EU Bioeconomy Strategy and Circular Economy Action Plan explicitly supports CCU as a way to turn CO₂ into feedstocks for chemicals, fuels, and materials, linking it to circularity and sustainability targets. ArcelorMittal and Mitsubishi Heavy Industries, Ltd. are working with a climate tech company, D-CRBN, to trial a new technology to convert CO₂ captured

at ArcelorMittal's plant in Gent, Belgium into carbon monoxide which can be used in steel and chemical production. The U.S. uses a combination of tax credits and funding to scale CCUs, particularly for CO₂-derived fuels and chemicals. The UAE's AI Reyadah project and planned CO₂-to-chemicals hubs leverage CCU with green hydrogen.

What are the risks ahead?

The foremost risk in scaling CCU in India is cost competitiveness. Capturing, purifying, and converting CO₂ is energy-intensive and expensive. Without policy incentives, CCU-derived products will struggle to compete with cheaper, fossil-based alternatives. A second risk lies in infrastructure readiness. CCU requires co-located industrial clusters, reliable transport of CO₂, and integration with downstream manufacturing, all of which are unevenly developed across Indian industrial regions. Finally, the absence of clear standards, certification, and market signals creates uncertainty for investors and limits demand for CO₂-derived products.

India has taken positive steps through the development of roadmaps to achieving CCU, and their appropriate implementation will be necessary for achieving India's goals.

Shambhavi Naik is chairperson, Takshashila Institution's Health & Life Sciences Policy,

THE GIST

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